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Piedmont Post

A Community Newspaper Serving the Citizens of Piedmont

Piedmont Police Names New Commander, Promotes Sergeant

By Jake Lannon

Piedmont Police Chief Frederick Shavies introduced the department's new Support Services Commander, Jodi Cornell, and the promotion of Sergeant Kristina Foster at the October 5 City Council meeting.

Cornell will oversee some of the department's most critical operations, including 911 and non-emergency dispatch, records management, property and evidence, and information technology systems. Her responsibilities include overseeing surveillance technology, such as automated license plate readers and body cameras, along with digital evidence storage and investigative databases.

Commander Cornell brings 21 years of law enforcement experience, including 16 years with the Pleasant Hill Police Department. There, she led several initiatives, including implementing a new computer-aided dispatch CAD system and modernizing the department's property and evidence section. As Support Services Commander, Cornell will serve as the official custodian of criminal justice records and oversee the handling and security of evidence and found property. She will report directly to Shavies on departmental operations and recommendations for improvements.

"Her experience, leadership, and perspective will be invaluable as we continue strengthening our operations and enhancing the services that we provide to the Piedmont community," Chief Shavies said.

See New Commander on page 7



How much does Jack weigh this year? Make your guess for $1 at the pumpkin patch.

Giant Jack takes bodily form at Wildwood Pumpkin Patch

By Jay Russell

Giant Jack has arrived at the Wildwood Dads Club (WWDC) Pumpkin Patch. The Atlantic Giant pumpkin was delivered last week, and the annual Guess the Weight Contest is underway at the Coaches Field patch, now open seven days a week.

Wildwood Pumpkin Patch volunteers have rallied to the cause, fundraising for Wildwood Elementary, and now have a centerpiece worthy of interstate travel to witness. New TK dad to the WWDC, Fletcher Berke, has taken to the volunteer cause immediately. "Some of my best and earliest memories came from the pumpkin patch as a Wildwood kid," said Berke. "I was excited to get involved."

Volunteer dads commonly bring their Wildwood students, teaching them the ins and outs of hard work and customer service. Wildwood student Karlo Soerensen even operated the point-of-sale transaction himself and played conductor by giving wagon rides

See Pumpkin Patch on page 7

Candidates' Q & A – City Council Week 7

By Jake Lannon

Each election cycle, the *Piedmont Post* provides extensive coverage of each candidate to help residents make informed voting decisions.

For this year's race, the *Post* will send one question per week to the candidates running for City Council until Election Day. The five City Council candidates vying for three open seats received the question on Tuesday, October 6, and were asked to reply in 200 words.

Week 7 question:

According to Piedmont's Flock Transparency Portal, Piedmont operates 57 license plate reader cameras and 150 agencies have access to Piedmont's data. Would you vote to renew the contract with Flock Safety, and what would you do to increase transparency efforts around the program? What limits, if any, would you place on which agencies can access the data?

Nancy Beninati
(NancyforPiedmont.com)

Automated license plate readers (ALPRs) can be a valuable tool for law enforcement to investigate and identify vehicles involved in criminal activity. But technology that collects information about people moving through our community requires appropriate oversight, accountability, and transparency.

Recently, the San Francisco Police Department (SFPD) revealed its ALPR data was accessed by out-of-state and federal agencies contrary to state law and without SFPD's permission. When SFPD officials raised the issue with Flock, a private company, they found the response unsatisfactory. A related issue arose in Richmond. These examples underscore that even when steps are taken to protect the information, oversight is necessary.

I have reviewed Piedmont's ALPR policy. Given recent concerns about ALPR technology and Flock specifically, there should be a community discussion to consider whether our policy needs updating and to ensure our daily movements are protected. Piedmonters should understand how these systems are used, who can access the data and under what circumstances, and what protections exist against misuse. Mandatory audits must be thorough.

See Candidates' Q&A on page 27

Changes to Math Pathways accelerate all 6th graders

By Jay Russell

Changes in mathematics course offerings, and the sequence in which students take them, are in the works for secondary Piedmont students (6-12 grades). A community meeting was held Tuesday, October 13 and the board has agendized changes to the math pathways as an action item in tonight's October 14 meeting.

At the high school level the changes will replace the integrated math classes, which integrate algebra and geometry, and return to an (AGA) model of Algebra I, then Geometry, then Algebra 2. At the middle school all 6th graders will take the advanced pacing Compression Math course next year.

If approved by the school board, teachers would begin piloting the new material in January of 2027 and it would be implemented next fall. High school students that are currently taking integrated math would continue with Integrated Math 2 or 3 next year. However, freshmen next year school year would start with the new programming offerings of Algebra 1 or Geometry instead of integrated math. This means integrated math would be phased out over the next couple years.

During the community meeting at Havens PHS and MHS Counselor Amanda Carlson asked, "How is this going to effect scheduling? I worry this will really pull on the schedule."

The content of high school math is not changed, but the order in which it is presented is grouped differently.

"Essentially, if you gave me a pair of scissors, I could cut out sections of our IM1, 2, and 3 books and rearrange them to create the three Algebra 1, Geometry, Algebra 2 books printed by the same publisher," explained Association of Piedmont Teachers Co-President and PHS Math teacher Sam Colburn.

Colburn explained that the pathways were presented to teachers in advance, but that their feedback has not been factored into the plan. The October 13 meeting at Havens was intended to bring parents up to speed on the proposed changes ahead of the October 14 school board vote.

According to a CaIMatters article, around 16% of school districts in the U.S. offer integrated math, and with a strong-hold of popularity stemming from California. Integrated math has its critics, so the changes at the high school level seem to face minimal resistance. Colburn said that IM2 curriculum is integrated "a bit awkwardly."

"[Integrated Math 2] feels like you're in a Geometry class for a few months, until about November, when suddenly you find yourself learning quadratics (a new and challenging topic for many Algebra 1 students)," he said.

The most controversial changes in the the math pathways plan may be the implementation of compression math for all 6th graders. This year around 70% of all 6th graders are taking the advanced pace "compression math"

See Math Pathways on page 27

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Piedmont Post

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Collecting photos for Where in the World

For 28 years, Piedmont residents have made sure their travels are well documented, with photos of family members reading the *Piedmont Post* in far-off places throughout the world, and some nearby.

The *Post* invites families to send photos with the *Post* from near and far for publication in *Where in the World Are We* on the back page of the paper. With people able to travel once again, there is no better time to have your photo in the *Post.*

Send photos as .jpg files to: news@piedmont-post.com, and be sure to include a brief description of the location where the photo was taken.

READ IT IN THE *POST*

Quote of the Week

"When a man becomes a fireman his greatest act of bravery has been accomplished."

– Chief Edward F. Croker
New York Fire Department

Opinion

City needs to fix hiring procedure at Fire Dept.

Editor:

We seek your assistance in making sure that Piedmont Firefighters are accorded salaries and health benefits in keeping with the fact that they are our Piedmont citizens' extended family in terms of their dedication to our health and safety.

We moved to Piedmont in 1993 and raised our two children here. We have experienced the intelligence, caring and decision-making of our Piedmont Firefighters. Had we not personally benefited from the firefighters' kindness and skill, we would still feel tremendous gratitude to them for being here just in case.

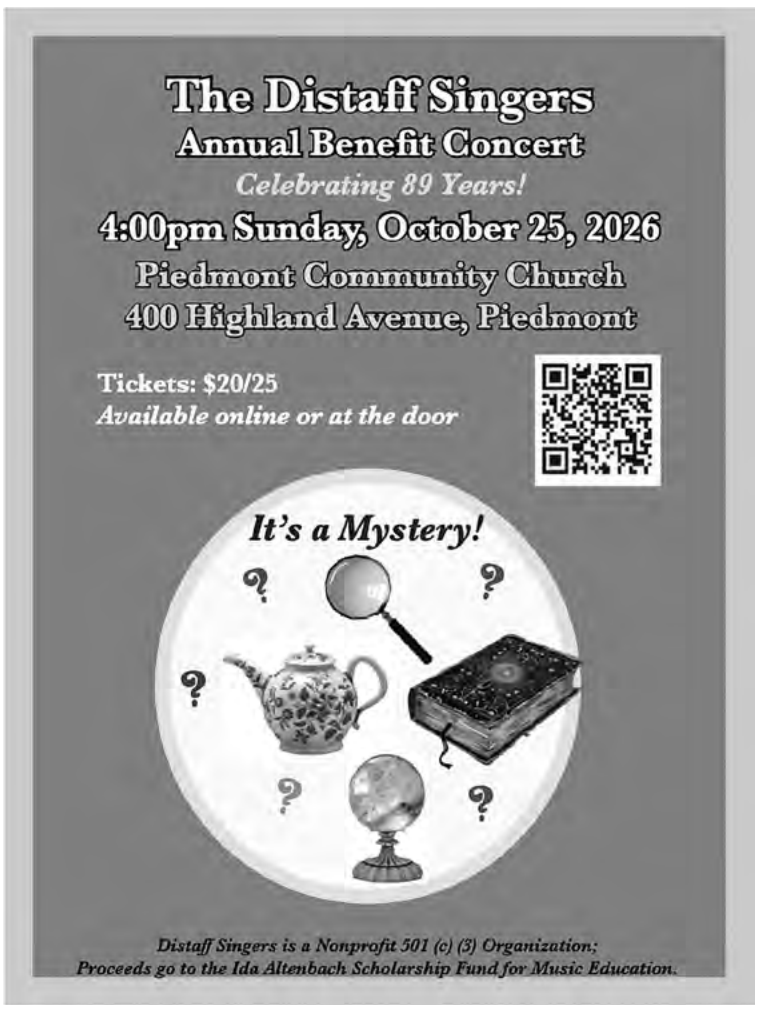
We were very distressed to read the article in the September 23 Piedmont Post indicating that negotiations between the firefighters and the city are at a standstill. We carefully read the firefighters' concerns about the necessity of 1) having pay increases to encourage longevity, and 2) having retirement benefits to cover firefighters' medical care for the period between retirement and Social Security eligibility. We share the firefighters' underlying concern about inadequate staffing which requires excessive overtime to keep us safe.

As residents and taxpayers, we support the firefighters' demands. Piedmont prides itself on being a city that is at the forefront of good decision-making. Piedmont needs to step up to support the firefighters and to inform its citizens what efforts and finances are required to do so. We rely on Piedmont Firefighters for our lives and the lives of our children. Is there anything more important? The firefighters' knowledge, skills, courage and work ethic should be celebrated and honored by accepting their demands.

We are both retired attorneys; Joe represented injured workers and clients denied social security disability; I practiced civil rights law. As residents of Piedmont, we find the city's response puzzling and extraordinarily short-sighted (using overtime instead of properly hiring, making the very hiring process discouraging by not providing the enticement of raises after certain years of service are reached, by not meeting the basic human need of health insurance until Social Security eligibility is reached).

We look forward to hearing from you.

–Susan Goldsmith and Joseph Waxman



How to get news in the *Post*

The *Piedmont Post* welcomes its readers to express their opinions on any topic. Columns in the *Piedmont Post* are exclusive and may not be reprinted without permission.

The *Post* reserves the right to edit any pieces or letters submitted. Opinion pieces should be limited to 400 words, letters to the editor to 200 words.

Photo submissions: Please submit photos at 6 inches in width and at a resolution of 200 dpi in jpeg format.

Do you have some news? Send your photos or stories to 3756 Grand Ave., #203, Oakland, CA 94610, or email them to news@piedmont-post.com. It's that easy. (Send us an attachment or cut and paste your text into the body of the email.)

The deadline for submitting news, photos and opinion items is Friday.

Letters to the Editor

Support Measure GG

Editor,

My family recently bought a home in Piedmont, and my husband and I will be voting yes on Measure GG. We chose Piedmont because of the quality of services the city provides from parks and pool to well-maintained roads and sidewalks and reliable police and fire services. Measure GG would increase the real estate transfer tax, a line item we shared with our home's seller, to help fund city operations and maintain the services that drew our family here.

As recent buyers, we can say that an additional one-time cost as represented by Measure GG would not have changed our decision to purchase a home in Piedmont. The quality of city services was a much more significant factor in our decision. Looking ahead, I am concerned that an inability to maintain these important city services could diminish the qualities that make Piedmont an attractive place to live.

–Katy Morsony

Why I'm Voting Yes on Measure GG

Editor,

Serving on Piedmont's Budget Advisory and Financial Planning Committee has taught me a lot about how our city's finances work, and it's why I support Measure GG to increase the real estate transfer tax rate.

Piedmont has great schools, safe streets, fast emergency response, and a strong sense of community. It's easy to assume a city like ours has vast financial resources. I assumed that too before joining the committee. In reality, our city's budget is more constrained than many residents realize.

Piedmont is almost entirely residential, so nearly all of our revenue comes from property: property taxes, the parcel tax, and the transfer tax paid when a home sells. Meanwhile, most nearby cities benefit from much larger commercial and industrial tax bases. Without that kind of tax revenue, Piedmont depends on the transfer tax in a way our neighbors simply don't.

Our 1.3% transfer tax rate was set 33 years ago and hasn't changed since, while the city's costs for salaries, pensions, insurance and construction have kept rising. Over the same period, most of our neighbors have raised their rates, several of them since 2018. At the average Piedmont home price, our current rate is lower than Berkeley's, Oakland's, Emeryville's or Albany's. Measure GG would raise it to 1.75%, generating about $1.5 million a year for police, fire, and maintenance of our roads, storm drains, parks and city buildings.

Transfer tax revenue does go up when home sales are strong, and we've had some good years. But sales rise and fall with interest rates and the economy, and a strong year doesn't fix the longterm gap between what the city needs to maintain and what it can count on.

Measure GG bolsters a one-time tax paid at the time of sale, and it addresses a real need I've seen firsthand. I hope you'll join me in voting yes.

–Billy Deitch is a Piedmont resident and member of the city's Budget Advisory and Financial Planning Committee. Views are his own.

For Measure GG

Dear Editor,

As we head towards the home stretch of the upcoming November 3rd election, and for those who have not yet decided, let me share with you my thoughts of why I support Measure GG.

As you may be aware, the City of Piedmont's annual budget is heavily dependent on real estate-related taxes, including transfer taxes, which account for about 10% of the City's General Fund budget. The transfer tax, which is assessed only when one's Piedmont property is sold, has not changed since 1993. One good year of transfer taxes does not change the structure of the City's annual budget.

At the City Council's direction, the Budget Advisory and Financial Planning (BAFP) committee explored options in addressing the City's long-term fiscal needs of maintaining its services and addressing its aging facilities and infrastructure. As one who was instrumental in the establishment of the BAFP committee, it is an open and transparent budget and planning process with all hearings open to the public. BAFP has a long-term view in the planning process and strongly recommended an increase in the City's transfer tax rate to 1.75% of the sales price, which is within the range of other Alameda County cities. If passed, Measure GG will generate an estimated $1.5 million per year to support general City services.

Please join me in supporting Measure GG.

–John Chiang,
former Piedmont Mayor

Adam Hundt for City Council

Editor,

"Take a great city to new heights" is the campaign motto, and Adam Hundt is the candidate we are supporting this year for Piedmont City Council. At this year's fall kickoff for the Havens Dads Club ("HDC" for the uninitiated), several Piedmont parents gathered around a warm backyard firepit to hear Adam's pitch and test its premise.

Why can't our great city move faster in building a safer and more sustainable Piedmont, including our RHNA housing commitments, by swiftly removing obstacles while respecting local inputs? Couldn't we reimagine our heart of downtown as not just Mulberry's, but also a vibrant town square with family-friendly businesses (e.g. pizza, ice cream shops)? Might we use the solid foundation inherited from previous City Councils, to accelerate progress infused with fresh views from a young Piedmont dad with a decade-plus of private sector leadership credentials?

Adam's most compelling ideas revolve around exploring new revenue opportunities and public-private partnerships to help take our community to the next level – not just for young families, but for all of us Piedmonters. Let's put him in a position to help us do just that.

–With warm regards,
Tim & Ana Carolina Stucka

Re-Elect Tom Ramsey to Piedmont City Council

This November, I'll be proud to cast my vote to re-elect Tom Ramsey to Piedmont City Council. Piedmont is so fortunate to be in the good hands of a committed, thoughtful and capable leader like Tom. I've had the great privilege of working with Tom for 4 years on Piedmont's Planning Commission. During that time, and throughout his tenure on City Council, I've been deeply impressed by Tom's approach to understanding complex issues and making thoughtful decisions. Tom emphasizes collaboration and cooperation between neighbors, and balances maintaining the character of the community with being open to design innovation. This approach was reflected in his exceptional leadership in revising Piedmont's Design Guidelines. His efforts have made the Design Guidelines more transparent and user-friendly for homeowners, architects and contractors alike. Tom's many years of engagement and service in Piedmont reflect his dedication to our community. Tom's professional expertise as an architect and executive has been extraordinarily helpful to City Council as Piedmont completed construction on its new pool and moves forward with complying with state housing laws. Finally, Tom's warm, collegial, and solutions-focused nature ensures that different viewpoints are respected and reflected in the Council's decisions on important issues facing our city. I look forward to electing Tom Ramsey to City Council. I hope you'll join me in casting your ballot for him in November.

–Rani Batra,
Former Chair, Piedmont Planning Commission

VIEWPOINT

Re-Elect Cindi Reiss for Peralta Community College Board Trustee, Area 5

Editor,

Fiscal stewardship is about public trust. How we manage public money shapes both the strength of our institutions and the trust our communities place in them.

Peralta's colleges play an indispensable role in the educational and economic landscape of Alameda County. Peralta expands educational opportunity close to home — giving Piedmont High students access to Calculus III and Linear Algebra classes though Peralta's Dual and Concurrent enrollment — creating affordable pathways to leading universities, helping adults prepare for new careers, or cultivating art and language skills. By reducing financial barriers and providing opportunities at different stages of life, the Colleges close gaps to access to higher education and economic mobility. Peralta directly shapes the opportunities available to families throughout Northern Alameda county.

When Cindi Reiss was first elected to the Peralta Community College District Board in 2018, the District faced serious financial instability, accreditation concerns, persistent leadership turnover, Board conflict, and the possibility of state intervention. Cindi brought to the Board the teaching perspective of a longtime tenured educator, the institutional insight of a former Accreditation Commissioner, and the governance and policy experience gained through local and statewide academic senate service. It is this unique lens that shaped her commitment to responsible fiscal governance.

The progress since 2018 is substantial: All four Peralta colleges are fully accredited. In 2026, a successful bond-refunding transaction saved taxpayers $52M. In 2026, Fitch assigned Peralta's new general-obligation bonds a AAA rating, while S&P assigned an AA-/Stable rating. The rating agencies cited improved financial practices, experienced management, stable Board leadership, and a forward-looking plan for long-term financial stability.

Board leadership matters. Cindi understands that a trustee's responsibility is not to pursue the easiest or most immediately popular course. It is to shape and protect the long-term fiscal and structural conditions that will allow Peralta to succeed and serve its students effectively even amidst declining enrollments and growing doubts about the value of higher education.

Peralta has moved from crisis toward stability, but stability is not the same as sustainability. The District must now implement its Transformation Plan, reduce unnecessary fragmentation and internal competition, strengthen educational pathways, and establish a financial structure that will endure beyond the tenure of any individual trustee or chancellor.

I support her reelection because Peralta needs her continued experience, institutional knowledge, independence, and principled stewardship to bring this work to completion.

Please join me in voting to reelect Cindi Reiss as Peralta Community College District Trustee, Area 5, on November 3.

–Melissa Wilk

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Local Items

Chief Brannigan presents new Alameda County extreme fire weather approach

By Jake Lannon

At the October 5 City Council meeting, Fire Chief Dave Brannigan presented a proposed countywide framework for community protective actions and fire department readiness when the National Weather Service (NWS) forecasts extreme fire weather. The proposal would designate "Leave Early" zones where, under "particularly dangerous" weather conditions, residents would be notified in advance to leave early in case of a wildfire.

The NWS typically issues a Red Flag Warning up to 24 hours before hazardous fire weather begins, often preceded by a Fire Weather Watch 24 to 72 hours in advance. Under this proposed framework, the NWS would add a Particularly Dangerous Situation tag to the red flag warnings that meet the weather conditions.

"One of the complaints that I personally had, and a lot of the fire service had, was calling red flag on days that don't do a lot of bad things in terms of fire behavior, and the fires that we have the most trouble with containing happen in very low humidity and very high winds. That caught their attention, and they've been engaged ever since," said Chief Brannigan.

The weather conditions that trigger a Particularly Dangerous tag are very rare. According to the report, they have less than a five percent chance of occurring. The conditions are: no rain for the past 24 hours, annual grasses have cured, extremely low humidity, and high wind speeds sustained for more than 8 hours or longer. Under these specific conditions, the NWS would notify the region of a Particularly Dangerous Situation 24 to 48 hours in advance.

This drafted approach takes inspiration from Australia's approach to fire communication. Under catastrophic weather conditions, they would notify people in high-risk areas to leave early before the conditions become dangerous.

"On these rare, very extreme weather days, we are proposing creating what we call leave early areas. Now these will be areas that we, as a community, decide where it makes sense to do this," said Chief Brannigan.

Within designated high-risk zones, there will be two categories: "Leave Early" areas and "Get Ready" areas. A Leave Early area would recommend residents leave their home and stay elsewhere before the extreme fire weather window begins and wait until conditions improve. A Get Ready designation recommends residents be ready to evacuate quickly and prepare an evacuation plan in case the situation gets worse.

"Whenever we firm up the plan, decide as a community where these areas are in Piedmont, how they line up with our surrounding communities. We will take a really intentional approach to community education and messaging beforehand, so that when it happens, we're able to send out messaging coordinated," said Chief Brannigan.

Over the next three months, the Alameda County Fire Chiefs Association intends to refine the approach, identify additional support tools, identify partners not yet involved, and identify any legislative changes that may be needed. The association plans to return a final draft for adoption by January 2027 for use in the 2027 fire season.

Shake Out on October 15

Refreshing earthquake safety knowledge

Pause what you're doing at 10:15 a.m. on Thursday, October 15, to practice what to do during an earthquake as part of the annual Great California ShakeOut. The Fire Department wants to understand how prepared the community is, what steps residents have taken, where they're vulnerable, and what might help them be more ready.

Complete the City's disaster preparedness survey at piedmont.ca.gov/DisasterSurvey. Answers will help identify where residents need more support and guide future programs and resources.

If you were taught to stand in a doorway when the ground starts shaking, it's time for a refresher. When the city quizzed residents at this year's Harvest Festival about what to do during an earthquake, most people gave that answer. Doorways don't protect against falling or flying objects, one of the most common causes of earthquake injuries. Instead, experts today recommend drop, cover, and hold on.

Anytime you feel shaking or get an earthquake alert, take these three steps immediately if you are able:

1. DROP to your hands and knees. This helps protect you from being knocked down by shaking.

2. COVER your head and neck. Crawl under a sturdy desk or table if one is nearby. If not, crawl next to an interior wall and use your arms to protect your head and neck.

3. HOLD ON until shaking stops. If you're under furniture, hold onto it and be ready to move with it if it shifts. Otherwise, keep your arms over your head and neck.

If you use a wheelchair or walker, lock your wheels, cover your head and neck with your arms, and hold on until the shaking stops. The most important thing is to act immediately. Don't run outside or move to another room while the ground is shaking.

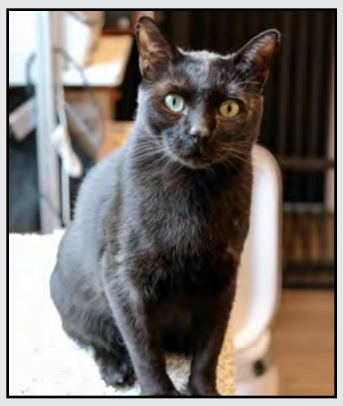
Having emergency supplies on hand can help you get through disruptions to essential services. Securing heavy furniture and considering seismic retrofits can reduce the risk of injury and property damage.



READ IT IN THE *POST*

Adoptable Cat of the Week

By Quinn White



Adopt Marvin through Cat Town.

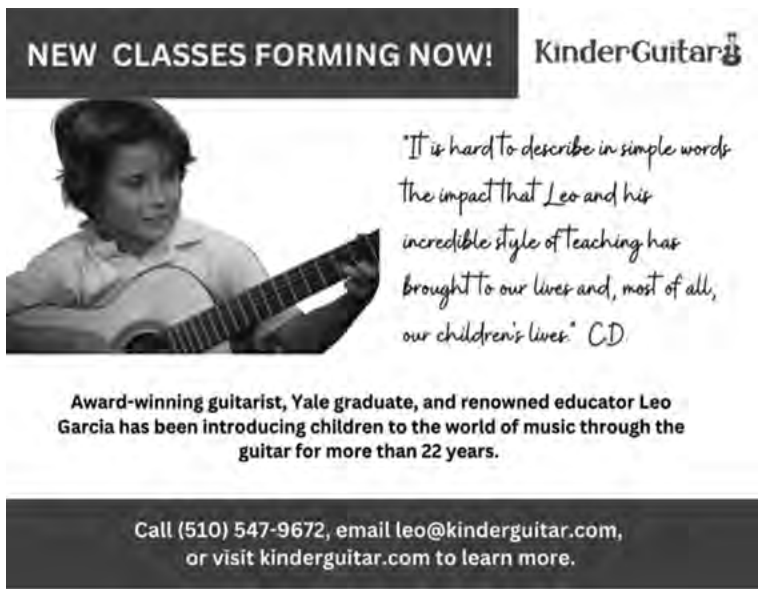
The moment you arrive home, an affectionate head presses against your legs. Vibrant green eyes gaze up at you, and you smile at a small, inquisitive chirp. Meet Marvin: a 5-year-old friend who wants you to be part of his day!

This sleek, black cat will follow you around, nap nearby, and occasionally sit in your lap. He enjoys his meals with you by his side, and when he wants attention, he simply sits, watches, and wills you to notice him.

Marvin is positive for FIV, a condition easily managed with indoor living and routine veterinary care. This sweet boy occasionally nips when he's bored, overly excited, or in new situations — so he'll do well with an adopter who can notice when he's starting to feel antsy and redirect his energy to toys, keeping his little mind busy with daily playtime.

You'll delight at seeing him scamper enthusiastically after his favorite wand toys and prance anything that rolls — from springs and fuzzy balls to blueberries.

Let us know you want this sweetheart to be your best friend! Marvin is neutered, vaccinated, microchipped, and FeLV-negative. Learn more at cattownoakland.org or email adopt@cattownoakland.org.



LWV to host political scientist Seth Masket for special luncheon

The League of Women Voters of Piedmont invites its members and community members to join political scientist and author Seth Masket for a special fundraising luncheon at the Center for the Arts, 801 Magnolia Avenue on Friday, October 30, at 11:30 a.m. His topic is: "Winning and Losing: How Do Our American Political Parties Remember and Forget?" Piedmont Mayor Betsy Smegal Andersen will introduce the speaker.

Masket, a University of Denver Professor, will shine a light on some of the surprising differences between how our political parties deal with losses and fight for survival. Appealing to voters of all parties, this talk by a leading scholar will raise important questions and point out intriguing dynamics about party identity, and how parties and their voters deal with wins and losses and hopes for the future.

Through interviews with party leaders, insiders, and voters reveals insights and contradictions in how our country's two main parties operate. His just-published book (June 2026), The Elephants in the Room: How Trump Voters Seized the Party from Republican Leaders, and prior volume (2020), Learning from Loss: The Democrats 2016-2020, provide unique–and remarkable–insights. With his dry sense of humor, he'll help answer the very timely question: How did we get here?

"Seth Masket's work allows us to step back from the daily political news cycle and examine how political parties actually work," said Lisa Gardner, President of the League of Women Voters of Piedmont. "For the League, informed and engaged citizens are essential to a healthy democracy. We hope this luncheon will encourage thoughtful conversation and greater understanding of the forces shaping our political system."

Tickets are $40 for LWVP members and $45 for nonmembers. Additional event information is available through the League of Women Voters of Piedmont.

Pre-registration is required. Get tickets at: https://bit.ly/4zsxRpB.

Oakland Mayor Lee secures $5 million for Fairyland

By Jay Russell

Oakland Mayor Barbara Lee announced on Monday, October 5 that Children's Fairyland has secured a $5,000,000 allocation from the state of California to close out phase one of its capital investment in the park. The funds are designed to facilitate the initial stages of restoration and revitalization.

"It's really a storybook that comes to life. Regardless of how old you are or young you are, my family can attest to the fact, this is a dream come true," said Lee.

Children's Fairyland CEO Kymberly Miller described details of the funding: $3,000,000 will be designated to the park's capital investment to make sure the park is well cared for in the next 76 years. The remaining $2 million will go to the park's general operations. The funds come from the state's budget which has allocated $14 million for Oakland community organizations, small businesses, public safety, and transitional housing.

"For 75 years, Fairyland has given Oakland's children a place to imagine what's possible. I still remember bringing my sons here, and today we're making sure the next generation gets that same magic. This $5 million is a proud victory for Oakland because every dollar we put into community spaces comes back to us in the children they raise," said Mayor Lee.

Children's Fairyland has been a vital part of Oakland's culture since opening in 1950. As the park that pioneered children's entertainment in this country, Fairyland forever changed the landscape of "family fun" as it is known today. Children's Fairyland is ten acres of green space on the shores of Lake Merritt, designed for outdoor play and low-tech, high-touch hands-on learning. It is a rare and increasingly precious resource for children.

The $5 million allocation will fund numerous initiatives within Fairyland's strategic capital investment plan, including essential infrastructure and facility upgrades. Fairyland CEO Miller describes the funding as foundational, rather than final.

"This funding is a launchpad, not a landing place. We have much more work to do to create the Fairyland of tomorrow. We're deeply grateful to Governor Newsom, Mayor Lee, and our State of California partners for recognizing what Fairyland means to this community, to Oakland, and to the entire Bay Area. We are laying the groundwork for Fairyland's financial sustainability so we can continue to be a safe and inclusive environment for playing and learning, where children build critical literacy skills and grow both socially and emotionally," said Miller.



Oakland Mayor Barbara Lee (left) and Fairyland CEO Kymberly Miller announced the state has granted Children's Fairyland $5,000,000 from the 2026-27 state budget.

The state funding is a commitment to ensure the 76-year-old iconic and beloved Oakland destination remains a safe, vibrant, and accessible oasis for generations to come. It also signals a broader shift underway at Fairyland. As an organization upheld and supported by its community, admissions, memberships, and the generosity of donors of all kinds, Children's Fairyland is now adding the kind of institutional support it needs to fuel the next phase of its modernization.

Learn more at Fairyland.org.

ADAM HUNDT
for Piedmont City Council

Dear Piedmont residents:

My name is Adam Hundt. I am running to be a member of the City Council. My wife is a proud Cal Bear. We are raising two young children, ages 2 and 4. Our 4-year-old attends the Havens TK program.

If elected, I will seek affordable options for home electrification and energy efficiency, lowering electricity bills and increasing home values. I can also use my two decades of education and business experience to find ways to attract small businesses into our town to provide family-friendly services such as a café or ice cream shop.

I will prioritize safety, ensuring our highly valued Police and Fire Departments continue to provide rapid responses to medical and other emergencies. I will help the city maintain its beautiful parks while addressing infrastructure needs including the improvement of sewers and storm drains.

I'm honored to be endorsed by the Alameda County Democratic Party, California State Controller Malia M. Cohen, California State Senator Jesse Arreguin (District 7), and many others.

Sincerely,

Adam Hundt

For more information, visit
adamhundt.com

Paid for by Adam Hundt for Piedmont City Council 2026, FPPC # 1496695



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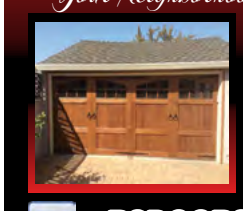
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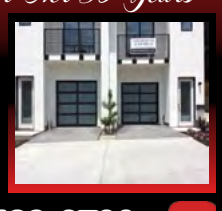


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Schools

Piedmont Branch Library News

Make Your Own Mini Piñata

Saturday, October 17 — 11:00 a.m. – 12:30 p.m.

Join us to make your own mini piñata! The piñata is a vibrant and iconic symbol of Hispanic and Latino/x culture, with a rich history that spans centuries and continents.

Originally used in Latin America to celebrate religious holidays, the piñata has evolved into a beloved tradition, especially at children's birthday parties. Today, it's a festive favorite across the U.S., bringing joy, color, and creativity to various gatherings.

In this hands-on activity, you'll get to make your very own mini piñata.

All materials will be provided, just bring your creativity!

While we'd love to accommodate everyone, keep in mind that space availability will be on a first-come, first-served basis.

Gardening Workshop: Edible Landscaping

Saturday, October 17 — 2:00 p.m. – 3:00 p.m.

Discover how to create a productive and beautiful edible garden!

A UC Master Gardener will guide you through selecting the right planting site based on sun and shade, preparing and improving your soil, watering, mulching, fertilizing, choosing what to plant, and managing pests at acceptable levels. Making informed decisions in these areas will help you enjoy a plentiful harvest throughout your garden.

All are welcome.

Toddler Storytime

Tuesday, October 20 — 10:15 – 10:30 a.m.

Songs, active rhymes and stories especially for ages 18 months to 3 years. Every Tuesday morning at 10:15 a.m.

Stay and play after Storytime with fun age-appropriate toys through 11:15 a.m. If conditions allow, Storytime will be held outside the library building.

We ask that patrons refrain from wearing scented products.

Chair Yoga

Thursday, October 22 — 10:30 – 11:30 a.m.

Chair yoga is designed for those who have difficulty getting up and down from the floor due to arthritis, knee injury, back pain or any other reason.

Learn from a certified yoga instructor how a daily practice will improve your strength, flexibility, and balance. Meditation elements are included to help you develop greater body awareness and to help you set your intention before the class.

Taught by local instructor Bett Bollhoefer, who is certified in Radiant Body Yoga.

Halloween Storytime for Toddlers

Saturday, October 24 — 10:15 – 10:30 a.m.

Join us Saturday morning for a cozy Halloween storytime at the library, especially for toddlers and their grown-ups. We'll share some silly, spooky stories and Halloween fun before the big parade down Piedmont Avenue!

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Valerie Lee & Robbin H. Lee, PHS alums

College Essay Revision Reset

By Steph Szczepanek

You've read your college essay so many times that the words are beginning to blur together. Now what?

When you're deep in the final revision stage, simply rereading the essay again and again becomes counterproductive. Try this instead:

1. Take a real break.

Step away from the essay for a day or two if your deadline allows. Work on another part of your application, go for a walk, spend time with friends, or focus on something completely unrelated. The goal is to interrupt your familiarity with the piece. When you return, you are more likely to read the essay as a new reader would, rather than seeing the version that already exists in your head.

2. Change the format.

Print it out, change the font, or read it on a different device. A new format can make familiar writing feel unfamiliar enough for you to notice problems.

3. Read it aloud.

Listen for sentences that feel awkward, repetitive, overly long, or unlike your natural voice. If you stumble while reading, the sentence may need attention. Remember, the college essay is a particular style of writing — it should sound like you. Reading aloud can help you remember what actually sounds natural, like a person — not a textbook or a résumé.

4. Revise one layer at a time.

Don't try to fix everything in one pass. Read once for the overall story and structure, once for specific details, once for sentence clarity, and once for grammar and spelling. Working in layers makes revision less chaotic. It also helps you recognize when a particular part of the process is complete.

5. Ask a fresh reader a focused question.

Instead of asking, "Is it good?" try: "What do you learn about me from this essay?" "Where did you feel most engaged?" "Was anything confusing or unnecessary?"

Feedback is most useful when it shows you the effect your writing is having. The purpose of revision is not to make the perfect essay — there is no such thing. You don't want to polish your essay until it sounds impersonal or nothing like you. Instead, a strong college essay offers a focused glimpse of who you are: how you notice, think, respond, question, change, or care. Revision helps that glimpse become clearer.

Steph Szczepanek is a member of the College Consulting team at Study Smarter. Study Smarter has been providing individualized academic tutoring, test preparation, and college counseling to Piedmont families since 1997. For more information, visit www.studysmarter.com, email info@studysmarter.com, or call (510) 350-8444.

School Board preview: Math, ebikes, Wildwood

By Jay Russell

Piedmont Unified School District's School Board will convene for a regularly scheduled meeting tonight, Wednesday, Oct. 14, at 7 p.m. in City Hall, 120 Vista Ave. A big item on the agenda will be a presentation about changes to the math pathways for sixth through 12th grade students.

The Math Pathways item will include a brief review and summary of the Special Board and Community Meeting that took place Oct. 13 at Havens Elementary. The presentation during the board meeting will outline a plan of action to pilot the new classes at the secondary level starting in January.

Implementing new math pathways is an action item and can be approved as early as this meeting. The district will also unveil the next steps to proceed with new course and curriculum implementation beginning in the 2027-28 school year.

Other items on the agenda include an update on the State of AC Transit routes in the city. This item will also give an overview of AC Transit's breadth of service, their financial restraints and overall route discontinuance.

A presentation by the Piedmont Police Department will outline e-bike and e-motorcycle safety. This presentation is informational and not a request for a new ordinance or for any specific legislative action.

A presentation on Measure GG will give updates about the measure on Piedmont ballots. Principal Amy Fry will give her yearly Wildwood State of School Presentation during this meeting as well.

The meeting can be participated in remotely via Zoom.us and also airs on KCOM-TV Channel 27.

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Pumpkin Patch

Continued from page 1

to kids around the Coaches Field patch in a Radio Flyer.

Prices at the patch have stayed the same for years, with great deals like Jarrahdale ornamental pumpkins for $15 and free Wee-Be-Little pumpkins for kids with colored-in pumpkin drawings. Redeemed drawings from students now adorn the entryway to the patch, adding student artwork to the ambiance of the local tradition.

The greatest bargain of them all will go to the winner of the Giant Jack weight-guessing competition. Guesses of Jack's weight cost $1, and one accurate prognosticator will win delivery — and removal — of Giant Jack for Halloween, instantly transforming any home's Halloween decorations into the best on the block.

The patch is WWDC's largest fundraiser of the year, and the funds go directly into projects at Wildwood Elementary, such as new playgrounds and technology upgrades.

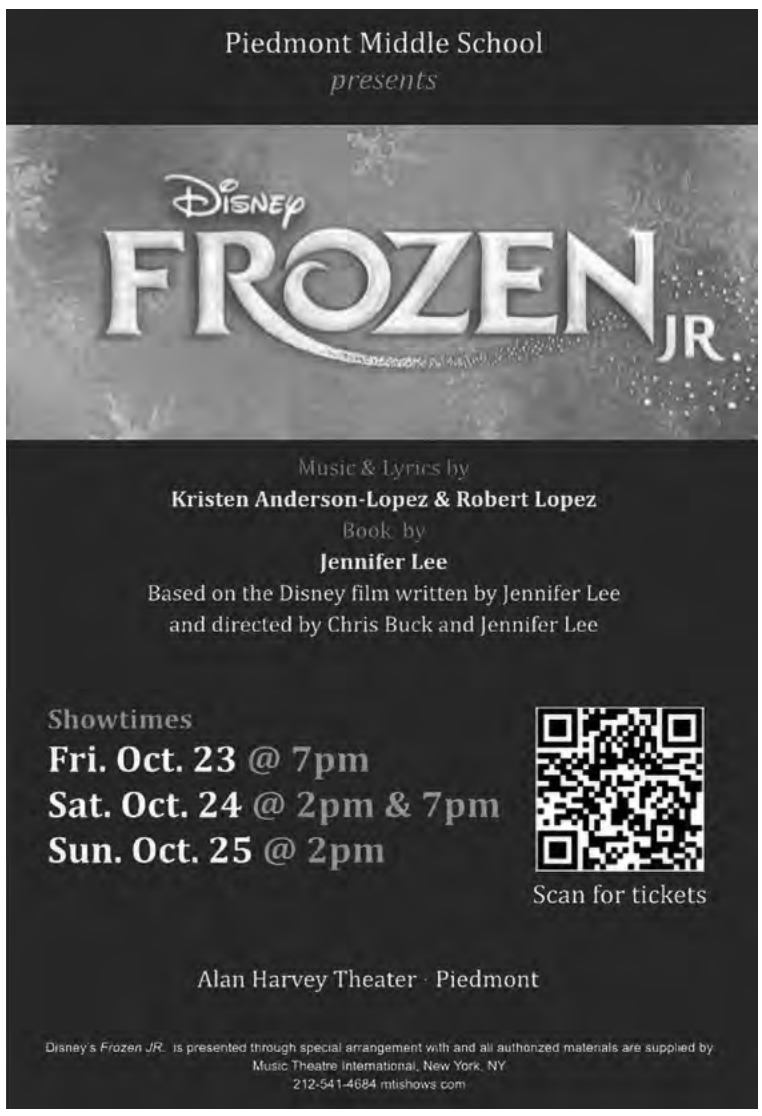
Go to Wildwooddadsclub.org/pumpkin-patch for a sneak peek of the impressive pumpkin variety on site.

Wildwood Dads Club Pumpkin Patch
Coaches Field
898 Red Rock Road
Weekdays: 4 to 6 p.m.
Saturday and Sunday: 10 a.m. to 6 p.m.



Ramona Russell, left, and Karlo Soerensen sit in the shadow of Giant Jack at the Wildwood Dads Club Pumpkin Patch.







PMS musical *Frozen JR.* coming October 23-25

By Amy Moorhead

Piedmont Middle School presents *Frozen JR.* October 23-25, based on the 2018 Broadway musical. The show features all of the memorable songs from the animated film, with music and lyrics by Kristen Anderson-Lopez and Robert Lopez, plus five new songs written for the Broadway production.

A story of true love and acceptance between sisters, F*rozen JR.* expands upon the emotional relationship and journey between Princesses Anna and Elsa. When faced with danger, the two discover their hidden potential and the powerful bond of sisterhood. With a cast of beloved characters and loaded with magic, adventure, and plenty of humor, *Frozen JR.* is sure to thaw even the coldest heart.

Frozen JR. runs approximately 75 minutes, which includes intermission, and is appropriate for the entire family. Performances are Friday, October 23, 7:00 p.m., Saturday, October 24, 2:00 p.m. & 7:00 p.m., and Sunday, October 25, 2:00 p.m. All performances are at the Alan Harvey Theater. Tickets are available for purchase online at https://phsmusicalsdance.ludus.com/index.php

YPSO returns from Finland & Sweden Tour

By Jake Lannon

This summer, Young People's Symphony Orchestra (YPSO), under the direction of Music Director David Ramadanoff, embarked on a nine-day concert tour of Finland and Sweden. YPSO performed at Sibelius Hall in Lahti and the Helsinki Music Centre in Finland, and at the Filadelfia Convention Centre Concert Hall in Stockholm.

The concert program featured works by American composers William Grant Still, Aaron Copland and Samuel Barber, along with Finnish composer Jean Sibelius's Symphony No. 1.

Between performances, the young musicians explored Helsinki, the UNESCO World Heritage site of Suomenlinna and the historic town of Porvoo before traveling overnight by ferry across the Baltic Sea to Stockholm. In Sweden, they visited Stockholm City Hall, home of the Nobel Prize banquet, Gamla Stan, the Royal Palace, the Vasa Museum, and Drottningholm Palace, combining their performances with the history and culture of Finland and Sweden.

Piedmont residents and PUSD students who were on the tour:

- Rosemary Li, Cello
  Piedmont High School
- Christian Lee, Percussion
  Piedmont High School
- Ian Nguyen, Viola
  Piedmont High School, Class of 2026
- Archie Yoshida, Violin
  Piedmont Middle School



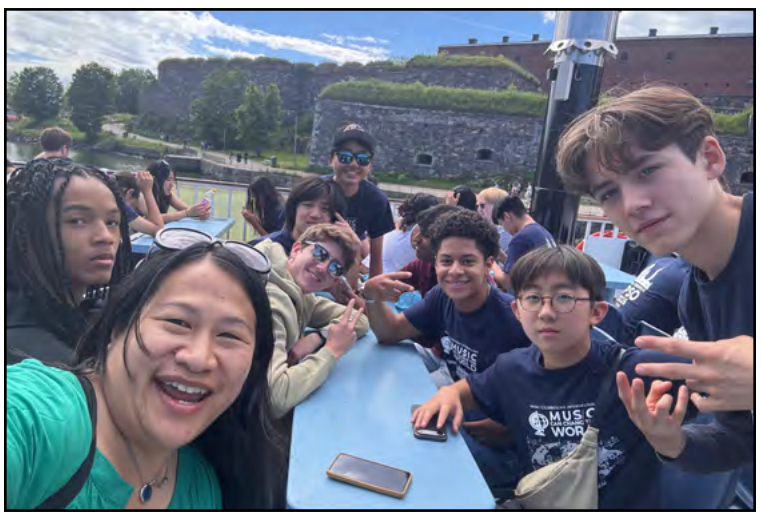
Music Director David Ramadanoff rehearses with YPSO at Sibelius Hall in Lahti, Finland.



YPSO musicians visit Helsinki's Sibelius Monument, honoring Finnish composer Jean Sibelius, whose *Symphony No. 1* they performed on tour.



YPSO cello and double bass musicians receive applause after the Helsinki Music Centre performance.
Photos courtesy of Chris Hsu and YPSO families



YPSO musicians and Executive Director Nadia Liu visit Suomenlinna, a UNESCO World Heritage Site in Helsinki.



YPSO brass musicians Sean Rudner, Dario San Marchi, Connor Rudolph, Jackson Lim and Ryan Luong are recognized after the Helsinki Music Centre performance.



YPSO musicians Timothy and Titus Cheung and Wesley Li-Bland explore Stockholm's historic Gamla Stan.



Music Director David Ramadanoff shakes hands with Co-Concertmaster Henry Stroud at the Helsinki Music Centre. Also pictured are Piedmont students Ian Nguyen and Archie Yoshida.



YPSO musicians explore Stockholm's historic Gamla Stan.



YPSO musicians celebrate their final night in Stockholm. Piedmont Middle School student Archie Yoshida is pictured on the left, second from back.



YPSO musicians celebrate their final night in Stockholm. Piedmont High School student Ian Nguyen is pictured on the left, second from front.

FUN4KIDS

Event Calendar

By Jay Russell

Oakland Zoo
Oaklandzoo.org
9777 Golf Links Rd, Oakland; 632-9525

The Oakland Zoo sets the standard for world-class animal care in captivity. Guests will marvel at the many species taking up residence at the zoo, while learning about conservation in the wild. The zoo is open every day from 9:30 a.m. to 4:00 p.m. Take the gondola to the amazing boardwalk of the California Trail, for viewings of wolves, buffalo and bears. Amusement rides, including a brand-new electric train, are open as well. Make sure to buy tickets in advance for timed entry.

Adventure Playground
Berkeleyca.gov
160 University Avenue, Berkeley; 981-6720

This unique playground will have kids entertained and engrossed in outdoor play for hours. The space is open Saturday and Sunday, 11:00 a.m.–5:00 p.m. The playground features kid-designed and built forts, boats, and towers. Children under the age of 18 must have a supervising adult registered to attend and watch them during their time at the playground because this park lets kids create with hammers, saws, paint, and recycled materials.

Chabot Space & Science Center
Chabotspace.org
10000 Skyline Boulevard, Oakland; 336-7300

Chabot is now open Wednesday-Sunday, 10:00 a.m. to 5:00 p.m., for a full day of fun and exploring the out-of-this-world exhibits. Older kids will love the shows in the planetarium and MegaDome, the boldest way to experience space and science, on the biggest of big screens. Every Friday and Saturday night the Chabot Observatory Deck has a free telescope viewing 7:30 to 10:30 p.m., as well, weather permitting, check their website for visibility status. Cleardarksky.com/c/ChbtSPC-CAkey.html?1

Leona Canyon Hiking Trail
Ebparks.org/parks/leona
Campus Drive off Keller Avenue, Oakland, CA

This East Bay Regional Park, just seven miles from Piedmont, is a hidden outdoor hiking gem. The pristine wooded canyon is protected in this 290-acre parkland near Merritt College in Oakland. It is a great place for hiking, running, dog walking and biking. Get outside of the house for a taste of fresh autumn air.

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Conna McCarthy, Vice Mayor
Lorrel Plimier, Councilmember
Tom Ramsey, Councilmember
Jennifer Long, Councilmember
Ruchi Medhekar, President Bd. of Education
Michael Malione, VP Bd. of Education
Susy Struble, Bd. of Education
Lindsay Thomasson, Bd. of Education
Max Roman, Bd. of Education
Jeremy Bowers, ret. Piedmont Police Chief
Teddy Gray King, Fmr. Piedmont Mayor
Jennifer Cavenaugh, Fmr. Piedmont Mayor
Susan Hill, Fmr. Piedmont Mayor
Michael Bruck, Fmr. Piedmont Mayor
Dean Barbieri, Fmr. Piedmont Mayor
Valerie Matzger, Fmr. Piedmont Mayor
Bob McBain, Fmr. Piedmont Mayor
John Chiang, Fmr. Piedmont Mayor
Jesse Arreguín, State Senate Dist. 7
Cory Smegal, Fmr. Bd. of Education Pres.
Sarah Pearson, Fmr. Bd. of Education Pres.

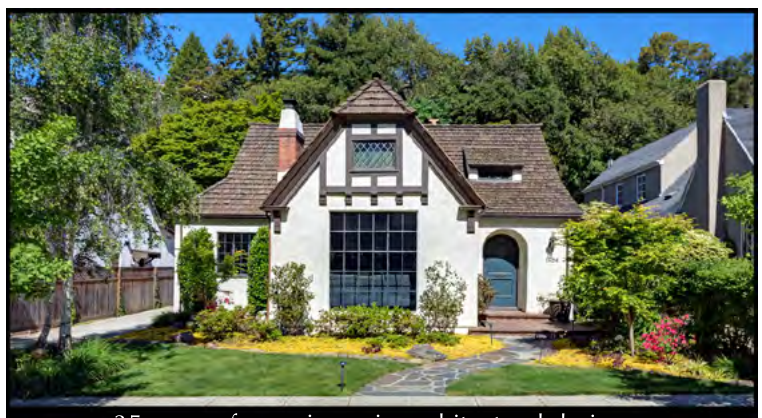


Ward Lindenmayer, Fmr. Bd. of Education
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John Tulloch, ret. Pied. City Clerk/Rec. Comm.
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Scan to see who else has endorsed Nancy

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Cub Scout Twilight Camp – fun after dark in Piedmont Park

Piedmont Council's Twilight Camp returns to Piedmont Park on October 27-29 with festive fun leading up to Halloween. With Twilight Camp's traditional rain gutter regatta back this year, campers will get to decorate and race their own pine boats, make spooky crafts to display for Halloween, and explore the park after dark by lantern light.

Camp starts at the amphitheater behind the Community Center in Piedmont Park at 6:00pm and runs until 7:30! Twilight Camp is open to all youth (Kinder to 5th) Cub Scout or not, though camp activities are geared toward a younger age (K – 3rd).

Interested youth can register for Twilight Camp through the Piedmont Recreation Department's Community Pass catalog (piedmont.ca.gov/activity guide). Registration is open until Friday, Oct 23rd.

Youth interested in joining Cub Scouts (K-5th), Scouts BSA (11-18 yrs), or Venturing (14-21 yrs) are encouraged to contact the Piedmont Council Scout Office for more information at 510-844-4752 or contact@piedmontbsa.org. Additionally, you can visit their website at www.piedmontscouting.org, or stop by in person at the Piedmont Scout Office at 10 Highland Way on the Community Church campus.





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STREET SWEEPING SCHEDULE – 2026-27

Street sweeping is critical for keeping storm drains clear during leaf drop season. Residents should move cars and any other obstacles blocking access to the curb off the street on street sweeping days.

October 12 - 23

Mon.	Tues.	Wed.	Thur.	Fri.
October 12	13	14	15	16
1-Even	**2-E**	**3-E**	**4-E**	**5-E**
October 19	20	21	22	23
1-Odd	**2-O**	**3-O**	**4-O**	**5-O**

E = Even Street Numbers O = Odd Street Numbers

ZONE 1
Ashmount Ave
Cambrian Ave
Cavanagh Ct *
Crest Rd
Crocker Ave
(South of La Salle Ave)
Croydon Circle *
Estates Dr
Florada Ave
Glen Alpine Rd
Hampton Rd
(East of Sea View Ave)
Huntleigh Rd
Indian Rd
Indian Gulch Rd
Inverleith Terr
La Salle Ave
La Salle Ct *
Lafayette Ave
Lexford Rd
Marlborough Ct *
Muir Ave
Sandringham Pl
Sandringham Rd
Sea View Ave
(Between La Salle & Crocker)
Selborne Dr
Somerset Rd
Sotelo Ave
St James Circle
St James Dr
St James Place
Trestle Glen Rd
Tyson Circle
Valant Place
Wildwood Gdns
Wistaria Way
Woodland Way
Wyngaard Ave

ZONE 2
Arroyo Ave
Bonita Ave
(North of Park Way)
Cambridge Way
(West of Grand Ave)
Estrella Ave
Grand Ave – *ODD*
(Bet Wildwood & Cambridge)
Grand Ave
(Between Cambridge & Rose including Lower Grand)
Greenbank Ave
(West of Grand Ave)
Holly Place
Howard Ave
Kingston Ave
Lake Ave
Linda Ave
Lorita Ave
Lower Grand Ave
Manor Dr
Monticello Ave
Nace Ave
Oakland Ave
(West of Grand Ave)
Olive Ave
Park Way
(Between Monticello & Bonita)
Parkside Dr *
Ramona Ave
Ronada Ave
Rose Ave
Sunnyside Ave
York Dr

ZONE 3
Arbor Dr
Artuna Ave *
Blair Ave
(Below Highland)
Bonita Ave
(South of Park Way)
Cambridge Way
(East of Grand Ave)
Carmel Ave
Dale Ave
Dracena Ave
El Cerrito Ave
Fairview Ave
Grand Ave – *EVEN*
(Between Wildwood & Cambridge)
Greenbank Ave
(East of Grand Ave)
Highland Ave
(North of Mountain Ave)
Highland Way
Hill Lane *
Hillside Ave
Hillside Ct **(Hand Blow)*
Jerome Ave
Keefer Ct *
Larmer Ct *
Latham St
MacKinnon Pl *
Magnolia Ave
Moraga Ave
(West of Highland)
Nova Dr
Oakland Ave
(Between Grand & Highland)
Park View Ave
(Between Magnolia & 241 Park View)
Park Way
(Between Bonita & Highland)
Ricardo Ave
San Carlos Ave
Sylvan Way
Vista Ave
Waldo Ave

ZONE 4
Abbott Way *
Alta Ave
Bell Ave
Bellevue Ave
Blair Ave
(Above Highland)
Blair Place *
Calvert Ct
Craig Ave
Dormidera Ave
Dudley Ave
Dudley Ct *
Echo Lane *
Hagar Ave
Hardwick Ave
Langdon Ct *
Littlewood Dr
Maxwelton Rd
Mesa Ave
Monte Ave
Moraga Ave
(East of Highland)
Mountain Ave
(West of Sharon)
Nellie Ave *
Oakland Ave
(Between Highland & Scenic)
Pacific Ave
Pala Ave
Park Way
(Between Highland & Pala)
Scenic Ave
Sharon Ave
Sharon Ct

ZONE 5
Annerley Rd
Boulevard Way
Caperton Ave
Crocker Ave
(North of La Salle Ave)
Crofton Ave
Farragut Ave
Guilford Rd
Hampton Rd
(West of Sea View Ave)
Harvard Rd
Hazel Lane
Highland Ave
(South of Mountain Ave)
King Ave
Lakeview Ave
Lincoln Ave
Mountain Ave
(East of Sharon)
Oak Rd
Oakmont Ave
Palm Dr
Park Lane
Park View Ave
(Between 241 Park View & Winsor)
Piedmont Ct *
(Hand Blow)
Poplar Way
Portsmouth Rd
Prospect Rd
Ranleigh Way
Requa Pl
Requa Rd
Richardson Way
Sea View Ave
(Between Mountain & La Salle)
Sheridan Ave
Sierra Ave
Wallace Rd
Warfield Ave
Wildwood Ave
Winsor Ave

Streets, by Zones — **Indicates streets where both even and odd addresses are swept on "even" days*

Subscribe to *Street Sweeping Email Updates* (https://lp.constantcontactpages.com/su/2tJcrMR/streetsweepalerts) to get reminders about upcoming street sweeping dates. The Piedmont Public Works Department sends out the weekly schedule to this list every Sunday during street sweeping season.

Street sweeping tips for residents

To help Piedmont's Department of Public Works keep the streets free of leaves during the fall and winter months, residents are asked to observe four rules:

1. Do not put branches in the street, even small branches! They damage the street sweeping equipment.
2. Do not sweep debris from your yard into the gutter – sweep only leaves that fall naturally into the street.
3. Sweep leaves into narrow rows outside the flow line of the gutter. Do not put them in piles. The street sweepers cannot pick up piles of leaves effectively.
4. If you want to rake your leaves, you can now add them to your weekly unlimited green waste cart. If you don't have enough room in your cart, free compostable bags are available at City Hall to place with your green cart on garbage day. Do not bag them and then empty the bags on the street on sweeping day. Compostable bags are also available from Republic Services (1-800-320-8077) for a fee.



PPD Blue

Excerpts from the Piedmont Police Department Log

October 2 – October 9

The Week by the Numbers
1 Catalytic Converter Theft
1 Hit & Run
1 Arrest
2 Automotive Burglaries
3 ALPRs triggered (Automatic License Plate Readers)

Friday, October 2

3:13 p.m. Highland Ave. Two-car accident between Kia Rondo and Toyota Tacoma. One party refuses to exchange info. Officer on scene, info exchanged.

7:10 p.m. Artuna Ave. Report of 2 juveniles on ebikes. Resident says they are being rude and screaming.

11:05 p.m. Olive Ave. Catalytic Converter Theft. Report of converter theft.

Saturday, October 3

11:08 a.m. Oakland Ave. Report of injured crow in street. Additional calls about woman in floral dress standing in road, alerting traffic so bird doesn't get hit.

Sunday, October 4

4:17 p.m. Moraga Ave. ALPR triggered by black 2024 Mini Cooper. Vehicle unable to be located.

Monday, October 5

5:32 a.m. Ricardo Ave. Report of man parked in black SUV for 5 minutes. Officer finds driver waiting to pick up ride.

8:18 a.m. Moraga Ave. ALPR triggered by 2013 blue Lexus LS460 reported stolen out of Oakland in 2025. Unable to locate.

11:22 a.m. San Carlos Ave. Report of cocker spaniel on the loose. Officer locates dog and returns to owner.

12:18 p.m. Oakland Ave. Animal control releases trapped skunk.

3:04 p.m. Moraga Ave. ALPR triggered by blue Lexus. Officer makes traffic stop, stolen plates are recovered, registered owner driving own vehicle.

Tuesday, October 6

3:15 a.m. Hampton Rd. Pedestrian flags down patrol car. Courtesy ride given to Lakeshore.

3:29 a.m. Kingston Ave. Silver Durango with expired registration tags towed away.

8:13 a.m. Maxwelton Ave. Auto Burglary. Report of rear license plate stolen off Honda Prologue.

1:04 p.m. Ramona Ave. Auto Burglary. Report of unlocked car rifled through. 50 cents stolen from coin tray.

5:05 p.m. Crocker Ave. Report of big black and white dog with Halloween scarf. Owner locates their canine.

Wednesday, October 7

1:24 pm. Oakland Ave. Report of deer stuck between 2 poles on fence. Animal Control able to free deer.

2:11 p.m. Palm Dr. Resident reports finding $400.

Thursday, October 8

8:09 a.m. Nace Ave. Report of man on bike rummaging thru items on a porch. Officers check, person cooperates, consent to search and let go.

9:00 a.m. Artuna Ave. Report of lost German Shepard mix. Animal control locates at lower Dracena field. Dog too fast to catch, owner on scene secures dog.

9:08 a.m. Moraga Ave. Report of finding phone under vehicle. Iphone with screen cracked turned into PD.

3:45 p.m. Grand Ave. Report

See PPD Blue on page 25



"The ideal solution would be for the Post Office to run the IRS, and Dude to run the Post Office.

Sports

Piedmont falls to Bishop O'Dowd

By Jonathan Comeaux

Piedmont High's girls' volleyball team lost to Western Alameda County Conference rivals, Bishop O'Dowd, 3-1 on Thursday, October 8 at Binks Rawlings Gym. The result brings the Highlanders' record to 14-10 overall and 3-4 against league competition.

With just three matches remaining on the schedule, the Highlanders are looking to fine tune some final things before the North Coast Section tournament on October 27 or 28.

"We've got a lot of little things to work on. We need better judgment in certain situations and have a lot of work to do on blocking. We also need the girls to be on the same page on defensive adjustments, but they are growing," co-head coach Mike Glass said.

"The biggest thing to tune up is just our connections to each other, finding spots on the court, finding ways to get kills, and also just working on our defensive setup. Sometimes it's hard to do that with a team that's so new," junior libero Allyson Huynh mentioned.

Against the Dragons, Piedmont had a strong second set to win by a dominant score of 25-15. Junior middle Lucia Dorsey was instrumental during the set with three blocks and two kills. However, Bishop O'Dowd started rotating away from her in the third and fourth sets.

"In the second set, Lucia took over getting multiple blocks, she made a big difference. But credit to the O'Dowd staff, they made some really good adjustments," Glass said.

Despite the loss, there was a nice crowd on hand for the Highlanders' benefit to send proceeds to The Cancer League to fight breast cancer. Huynh led setting up the night.

"It meant so much to me. It was a lot of work and the student section really showed up for us. We're raising money for such a good cause. Volleyball is such an exciting sport, I really hope the students who came today really noticed that," Huynh said.


Staff Photos

Lucia Dorsey (13) celebrates scoring a point against Bishop O'Dowd after recording one of her five blocks on the night



Allyson Huynh (4) celebrates a point in front of Piedmont's students' section.



Mia Bechtel sets up a spike for Charlotte Bailey.

Match Recap

Piedmont won one game 25-15, and lost three, 25-18, 25-22, and 25-15.

There were five total lead changes in the first set, including the Highlanders holding leads at 6-5 and 10-9. The Dragons took over at 11-10 and ever relinquished their advantage.

In Piedmont's second-set win, they scored the first six points of the set and lead 8-1 early on. BOD inched closer to cut the deficit to 9-5, but PHS went on a 5-0 run with two kills by Olivia Bailey, one by Maika Ting, and an ace by Mia Bechtel. Both teams traded points for the remainder of the set, with PHS maintaining an eight-point lead through much of it. At 21-14, PHS closed with four of the final five points with two kills by Ting and a block by Bailey.

In the third set, Piedmont led 2-0 to start by O'Dowd took over at 3-2 and never gave back the lead. Down 10-5, the Highlanders cut the lead to one multiple times, including at 23-22 – but Piedmont couldn't overtake and two consecutive offensive errors closed the set for O'Dowd.

The visitors never trailed in the fourth set, but Piedmont hung tight until around 13-10 when O'Dowd went on an 8-2 scoring run to lead 21-12. They closed with four of the final seven points.

Final stats: Ting had 13 kills, one ace and six digs. Olivia Stevens had six kills, five aces, 11 digs and three assists. Dorsey had three kills, three digs, and five blocks. Sofia Meyer had three kills, one dig and one assist. Bailey had two kills and two blocks. Fiona Olsen had two kills. Nora Trombi had two kills. Corina Vora had two kills, five digs and 20 assists. Dando had one kill and two digs. Huynh had 17 digs and three assists. Bechtel had one ace, four digs and six assists. Sarina Hill had four aces.

NEXT UP

Piedmont (14-10 overall, 3-4 league) visits Berkeley today, October 14, at 6:30 p.m.

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Athletes of the Week: Viviane Oesterer, Vaha Mafi

Honorable Mention: Ella Ruthven, Henry Stein



Viviane Oesterer earns Athlete of the Week after leading Piedmont to a fourth-place finish at the Asics Clovis Invitational.

By Jonathan Comeaux

We're awarding Viviane Oesterer of cross country and Vaha Mafi of football our Athletes of the Week. Our honorable mentions go to Ella Ruthven of girls' tennis and Henry Stein of boys' water polo.

VIVIANE OESTERER

Viviane Oesterer earns Athlete of the Week for leading Piedmont High at the 47th annual Asics Clovis Invitational, finishing 11th of 145 athletes with a time of 20:24 on the 5,000 meter course. She helped her school finish fourth of 20 schools in the Division 6 category. Oesterer has led the Highlanders in four of five meets this season.

VAHA MAFI

Vaha Mafi earns Athlete of the Week for his two-touchdown performance in Piedmont's 35-20 win over Arroyo. His award goes past recording 50 rushing yards on just four carries, but reflects his effort to recover from a torn ACL he suffered in 2025. In two appearances, Mafi has already logged three touchdowns, in addition to being a defensive starter.

Honorable Mentions

Ella Ruthven earns an honorable mention for her win at No. 1 singles in Piedmont's 6-1 victory over Justin Siena. Ruthven defeated the Braves' top starter, Lyla Hogan, in three-sets, 6-1, 1-6, 10-6. The victory avenged a 6-4, 6-2 loss

See Athletes of the Week on page 28



Vaha Mafi earns Athlete of the Week for his two-touchdown performance after recovering from a torn ACL he suffered last year.



Ella Ruthven earns an honorable mention for her win at No. 1 singles against Justin Siena.

Piedmont tennis team bashes Justin Siena 6-1



Ella Ruthven won in three sets at No. 1 singles against Justin Siena, avenging a loss from last year's NCS Individual Tournament.

By Jonathan Comeaux

It was a dominant 6-1 win for Piedmont High's girls' tennis team over Justin Siena in Napa on Wednesday, October 7. The result improves Piedmont's record to 10-4 overall with five matches left in the regular season. The Western Alameda County Conference Individual Tournament is on November 6.

"We traveled for an hour and arrived in that very hot Napa weather and played some glorious tennis," coach Jim Landes said.

The Highlanders look ahead to a critical league match against Alameda today, October 14, in a battle that could determine the fate of the 2026 regular season champion. It marks the first of two matches against the Hornets, with the second being the season-finale on October 28.

Against the Braves, Piedmont won three of four singles matches and swept all three doubles.

"All three of our doubles teams got off the court quickly without the loss of a set," Landes said.

At singles, sophomore Ella Ruthven had a big three-set win at the No. 1 spot by scores of 6-1, 1-6, 10-6. She defeated Lyla Hogan, who beat Ruthven 6-4, 6-2 in last year's Division 2 North Coast Section Individual Tournament.

"Ella's win against Lyla Hogan avenged a straight set loss in last season's NCS Individual, showing the improvement Ella's has made this year. She was able to control most of the points with good direction on her groundstrokes and varied spin, speed and height of her shots," Landes said.

Also winning at singles was Faith Chin at No. 2 in straight sets, 6-3, 6-2. Maddy Huynh won 6-3, 6-3 at No. 3, while Leela Sivakumar fell in three sets at No. 4 by scores of 1-6, 6-4, 10-8.

"Leela played very well but suffered a little more in the heat but still almost pulled out a very good three-set match. Our two other singles players, Faith Chin and Maddy Huyhn, both dominated their opponents and won in straight sets," Landes said.

At doubles, Emma Chan and Chiara Silvio won handily at the No. 1 spot, 6-1, 6-3. Ella Thomasson and Katie Pham featured at No. 2, winning a close first set before handling the second, 7-5, 6-3. At No. 3 was Paige Chin and Layla Reed-Miguel, shutting out their opponent in the second set of a 6-2, 6-0 victory.

NEXT UP

Piedmont (10-4 overall, 3-0 league) host Alameda today, October 14, at 3:30 p.m. They also visit Berkeley tomorrow, October 15, at the same time



Emma Chan won her match at No. 1 doubles against Justin Siena alongside Chiara Silvio.



Paige Chin won her No. 3 doubles match against Justin Siena with Layla Reed-Miguel.

Boys' water polo team beats CV

Highlanders split matches at Monterey Invitational

By Jonathan Comeaux

Piedmont High's boys' water polo team won three of its last five matches, bringing their record to 9-10 overall with just two matches left in their regular season. The Highlanders beat Castro Valley 10-9 in a Western Alameda County Conference battle at the Piedmont Pool on Tuesday, October 6, while they won two of four matches at the Monterey Invitational Tournament on Friday and Saturday, October 9-10.

At the tournament, Piedmont beat host school Pacific Grove 15-9 on the opening day but followed with a 14-0 loss to Santa Cruz. The next day, they lost 19-5 to Carmel, and beat league rivals Bishop O'Dowd 14-11.

Piedmont's final match of the regular season will be hosting O'Dowd on Tuesday, October 20. It marks as a precursor to the start of the WACC Tournament on Tuesday, October 27.

10-9 over Castro Valley

PHS opened with a 2-0 lead through the first quarter with goals by Rylan Patty and Walker Wilson. The Highlanders then landed three straight goals in the second quarter by Patty, Henry Stein, and Wilson to lead 5-0 with 1:14 left.

The Trojans scored once before halftime to make it 5-1, but went on a four-goal run in the third quarter to tie it at 5-5 with 1:53 remaining. From there, Stein scored with 49 seconds left, but CV tied it again with four seconds remaining.

In the fourth quarter, Piedmont found its rhythm again with three straight goals. Stein scored back-to-back at 6:50 and 6:01, while Patty made it 9-6 with 4:56 left. After a CV goal, Stein made it 10-7 with 3:49 on the clock. The Trojans got its final goals with 2:21 and 1:23 remaining, while both teams traded possession to end the game.

Final scorers: Stein had five goals, Patty had three, and Wilson had two.

15-9 over Pacific Grove

Piedmont led 3-2 through the first quarter and extended the gap to 9-5 by halftime. Both teams logged four goals in the third quarter to make it 13-9, while the Highlanders landed two goals in the final going without conceding. Jerez notably had seven saves in the fourth quarter.

Final stats: Patty scored six goals, one assist, and a steal. Stein had five goals, five assists, and one steal. Henry Van Den Bos had two goals and an assist. Oliver Hurwitz had one goal and steal. Colin Amen scored once. Wilson had two assists and two steals. Jerez had 14 saves, four steals, and an assist.



Henry Stein led with five goals in a critical league win over Castro Valley. He also had 11 goals and 11 assists at the Monterey Invitational Tournament.



Rylan Patty had 19 goals in a five-match span.



Walker Wilson had two goals in Piedmont's big win over Castro Valley.

14-11 over Bishop O'Dowd

Piedmont dominated the first quarter to lead 6-1 through the first seven minutes. O'Dowd inched closer to 8-4 in the second quarter and 10-7 through the third. Both teams scored four goals in the final quarter.

Final stats: Patty had seven goals, two assists. Stein had four goals, five assists, and a steal. Van Den Bos had one goal. Wilson had one goal and steal. Hurwitz had one goal, assist, and three steals. Jerez had 12 saves.

Tuesday vs. Lick-Wilmerding

Piedmont visited Lick-Wilmerding in San Francisco on Tuesday, October 13. See next week's Post for match details.

NEXT UP

Piedmont (9-10 overall, 2-2 league) host Bishop O'Dowd on Tuesday, October 20 at 6:00 p.m.

SPORTS SCHEDULE

Piedmont

10/14/26

Date	Day	Sport	Opponent	Loc.	Var.	JV.
Oct. 14	Wed.	GG	Arroyo, Castro Valley			
			At Lake Chabot GC	A	3:30	3:30
		TEN	Alameda	H/A	3:30	3:30
		VB	Berkeley	A	6:30	5:30
Oct. 15	Thurs.	TEN	Berkeley	A/H	3:30	3:30
		FF	Bishop O'Dowd	H	7:30	6:30
Oct. 16	Fri.	FB	Castro Valley	A	7:00	4:00
Oct. 20	Tues.	TEN	Bishop O'Dowd	H/A	3:30	3:30
		WP-B	Bishop O'Dowd	H	6:00	5:00
		VB	Castro Valley	A	6:30	5:30
		FF	WACC Tournament	TBD	TBD	------
Oct. 21	Wed.	XC	Mid-Season Mania Invitational			
			At Campolindo, Moraga	A	3:00	3:00

KEY

H = Home A = Away

FB = Football WP-B = Boys' Water Polo FF = Flag Football

VB = Girls' Volleyball GG = Girls' Golf

TEN = Girls' Tennis XC = Cross Country

Piedmont girls place 4th at Asics Clovis Invitational

By Jonathan Comeaux

Piedmont High's cross country team traveled to the 47th annual Asics Clovis Invitational at Woodward Park on Friday, October 9. The girls' team came away with a fourth place finish out of 20 schools in the Division 6 category, while the boys placed 13th of 28 in their D6 race.

The event was held on the same course that is run at the State Championship.

"This was a busy weekend for Piedmont cross country. Our varsity teams traveled to Fresno for the Clovis Invitational at Woodward Park, followed by our junior varsity group racing the Wildcat Forward Motion Invitational on Saturday. There was a lot to like from both meets. At Clovis, our runners had the opportunity to race on the State Championship course against excellent competition from throughout California," coach Steve Zirkelbach said.

It was another strong run by junior Viviane Oesterer, leading the Highlanders to an 11th place finish out of 145 athletes with a time of 20:24 on the 5,000 meter course. Behind her was senior Cora Brozowski Schrader finishing 21st in 21:13.5.



Viviane Oesterer (3557) placed 11th of 145 runners at the Clovis Invitational.



Viviane Oesterer (3557) placed 11th of 145 runners at the Clovis Invitational.

"Viviane and Cora both did an excellent job of moving through the field. Rather than getting caught up in the fast start, they continued to pick off runners as the race progressed, moving up places each mile. That is exactly the kind of racing we have been talking about all season: stay composed early, keep competing through the middle of the race, and work hard to pass as many runners as possible later in the race," Zirkelbach said.

Rounding out their best five times was junior Nikita Gorelik in 33rd in 21:43.1, senior Amalia Gray was 40th in 21:59.6, while sophomore Madeleine Ewen placed 79th, 23:19.3.

For Gray, it was her first race of the season after recovering from an injury.

"Amalia produced one of the better finishes of the day. She was still racing people all the way through the line and passed several runners late in the race, exactly when places are often decided," Zirkelbach said.

As for the boys' side, they were led by junior Dresden Schulte-Sasse in 41st of 193, clocking a time of 17:14.4 on the 5K course. Close behind him was senior Alex Schleuning in 44th in 17:18.2.

"At the front, Dresden and Alex gave us another strong 1–2 performance. Having two runners this close together at the front gives us an important foundation as we move toward the championship meets," Zirkelbach said.

Sophomore Dylan Wallway was next in, finishing 72nd in 18:15.3. Rounding out their best five times was freshman Cormac Ross in 113th in 19:15.7 and sophomore Blake Riif in 121st in 19:29.1.

Zirkelbach highly praised Ross following the meet.

"One of the particularly noteworthy stories on the boys' side was freshman Cormac Ross, who earned one of the coveted spots on our varsity roster for the trip to Fresno. Earning that opportunity as a freshman is an accomplishment in itself, and Cormac showed that he belonged there. Cormac has emerged as one of our strongest young runners this season, and getting the opportunity to travel and race at Clovis as a ninth grader is valuable experience that should serve him well in the years ahead," Zirkelbach said.

NEXT UP

Piedmont next races in October 21 at the 2026 Mid-Season Mania 3200 Invitational at Campolindo in Moraga. Events start at 3:00 p.m.



Piedmont's girls' cross-country team finished fourth of 20 schools in the D6 race at the Asics Clovis Invitational. Pictured are Nikita Gorelik (left), Viviane Oesterer, Amalia Gray, Cora Brozowski Schrader, Madeleine Ewen, and Annie Thornton.

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JV falls to Arroyo on last-second Hail Mary



Photos by Graham Smith

Lev Kuluva during his big 71-yard touchdown run against Arroyo.

By Robby Koch

In a game that nearly ended in a tie, Piedmont High's junior varsity football team fell 20-12 to the visiting Arroyo Dons by way of a last-second Hail Mary that turned a 12-12 deadlock into a loss.

Penalties, fumbles, and a costly interception kept the offense behind the sticks all night, while the defense missed an uncharacteristically high amount of tackles. Even so, the team was tied with eight seconds left against a gritty Arroyo squad.

Lev Kuluva put the team on the board in the first quarter, scoring the first touchdown of his career on a rollout Z reverse. He juked the safety and raced 71 yards to the house, showing off the speed he gained on the track team last year. That score marked the first time since 2024 a touchdown was scored on the reverse for the JV Highlanders.

In the third quarter, Will Dietrich hauled in a 60 yard interception returned for a touchdown. But Arroyo answered with two straight touchdowns to even the at 12-12.

With eight seconds left in the game, the Dons hurled a desperation pass to the end zone, leading to one of their receivers coming down for the catch to leave Piedmont's JV squad stunned.

Defensively, Ernie Hildreth had a strong day with a huge stop to cause a turnover on downs at their own 10 yard line with a ferocious tackle. Robby Koch also recorded an interception, marking his second in two straight games. Ozem Fitzgerald also had a nice game, shedding blocks and racking up six tackles at defensive end.

On offense, the team stuck to its trap and toss plays, and the backs combined for about 100 yards, averaging over five yards per carry. The team finished with about 200 total yards, but turnovers and penalties held them to 12 points. Hildreth also ran for about 80 yards, including four carries of at least 10 yards.

NEXT UP

Piedmont (3-3 overall) visits Castro Valley on Friday, October 16 for a 4:00 p.m. game.



Ernie Hildreth had a big day offensively and defensively for the JV Highlanders.



Staff Photos

Vaha Mafi scored had two touchdowns in his second varsity game.

Highlanders open league schedule with big win over Arroyo

By Jonathan Comeaux

Piedmont High's football team got back in the win column on Friday, October 9 at Witter Field, beating the visiting Arroyo Dons 31-20 in their Western Alameda County Conference Mission Division opener. The result improves Piedmont's record to 2-4 overall with four games to play.

It was a strong second half for the Highlanders after going into the break in a 14-14 deadlock, outscoring the Dons 21-6 in the second half.

"From a coaching perspective, it shouldn't have been that close. We were kind of stumbling around in the first half, but gained energy in the second half. We're a super young team, and we're learning how to execute consistently," coach Jordan Seiden said.

Junior running back Vaha Mafi had a big game, scoring two touchdowns on four carries for 50 yards.

"As a player, I've just been staying hungry. They were on an inside run, I took it upon myself to grab the ball. I just wanted to make a huge play and show how I can support this team," Mafi said of the plays.

For Mafi, their September 25 game against Moreau was the first of his varsity career, taking a full year to recover from a torn ACL he suffered on September 19 of last year against Aragon.

"Coming back from an injury is truly a blessing. It happened last year against Aragon after forcing a fumble. Coming off this injury, I want to thank my mom and my dad for having my support. They truly mean everything to me. Just being back is truly amazing, and I have to thank the Lord and my parents for having my back," Mafi said.

The result marks the end of a three-game skid for the Highlanders, putting together one of their most complete performances thus far.

"Our execution came back, we did everything right. Some things don't go our way, but we stayed determined and on track. The line played great, defense played great, and everyone had a game tonight," running back Rehan Mumtaz said.

Game Recap

Arroyo scored the game's first touchdown with 5:47 left in the first quarter, but the Highlanders answered with an eight-play, 78 yard drive. The series featured a 19-yard reception by Mateo Long on 3rd-and-15, and capped off with a 14-yard touchdown by Long on a screen play to the left side to make it 14-14.

The Dons scored on its next possession to take a 14-7 lead with 10:20 left in the second quarter. But PHS came right back to score on its next drive on a 76-yard series on eight plays. This time, Mafi finished the drive with a one-yard touchdown carry with 5:43 left in the first half.

Piedmont got the ball to start the third quarter, making it count on an exhaustive 17-play, 69 yard series. It featured PHS converting a 3rd-and-2 and 4th-and-2 with a hard count by quarterback Cyrus Emanuelson to draw Arroyo offside. Mafi scored his second touchdown on 3rd-and-10 from the 22 to give his team a 21-14 lead.

PHS' defense forced a turnover on downs at their own 33, leading to a six-play touchdown drive that included a 25-yard catch and run by Long. For the touchdown, Emanuelson found Henry Brennan for a four-yard catch, making it 28-14 with 16 seconds left in the third.

After Arroyo scored but failed their point after attempt to make it 28-20 with 4:35 remaining, PHS answered on its next drive. At the end of a 64-yard drive, Rehan Mumtaz put a dagger in the game with a 21-yard carry with 1:27 remaining.

Final stats: Emanuelson completed 12 of 24 passes for 164 yards and two touchdowns. Mumtaz had 147 yards on 19 carries and one touchdown. Mafi had 50 yards on four carries and two touchdowns. Long had four receptions for 117 yards and a touchdown. Brennan had three receptions for 21 yards and a touchdown. Mason Gray had a fumble recovery.

NEXT UP

Piedmont (2-4 overall, 1-0 league) visits Castro Valley on Friday, October 16 at 7:00 p.m.



Rehan Mumtaz had 147 rushing yards on 19 carries and one touchdown.



Mateo Long had four receptions for 117 yards and a touchdown.



Arts & Entertainment



Photo courtesy of Haines Gallery

Haines Gallery at Fort Mason presents "250 Years, Indigenous Futures"

By Allyson Aleksey

Haines Gallery at San Francisco's Fort Mason presents "250 Years, Indigenous Futures," a group exhibition featuring work by eight Native American artists.

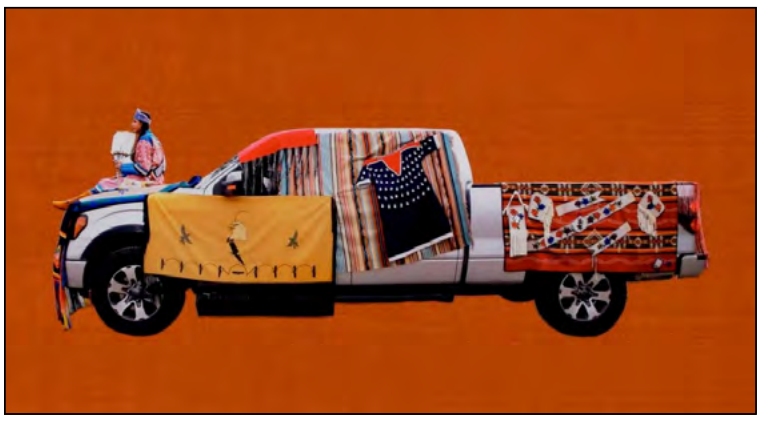
The exhibition features Victoria Grace Canby, Jordan Ann Craig, Sky Hopinka, Brad Kahlhamer, Terran Last Gun, Jamie Okuma, Wendy Red Star and Keith Secola. The artists work across painting, drawing, sculpture, photography and film.

The works draw from a wide range of sources, including Piikani painted lodges, Northern Cheyenne beadwork, the 1969-71 occupation of Alcatraz Island by the Indians of All Tribes, the annual Crow Fair, horror films and archival photography.

Among the artists featured is Marin-based Victoria Grace Canby, whose new works on paper depict the Three Sisters — corn, beans and squash — as a model of resilience, healing and collective care. Jordan Ann Craig's paintings combine references to Northern Cheyenne beadwork and quillwork with the work of modernist painter Agnes Martin.

Sky Hopinka's film "Sunflower Siege Engine" connects the occupation of Alcatraz with Cahokia Mounds in Illinois, while Brad Kahlhamer's "Pima Air + Space" features birds, horses and masked figures rendered in acrylic, ink and pencil on a bedsheet.

Terran Last Gun created a series of works inspired by the geometric designs of Piikani painted lodges, while Jamie Okuma's "Of Love and Sacrifice: Motherhood" combines intricate Payómkawichum (Luiseño) beadwork with imagery from the 2018 horror film "Suspiria."



"Chiaxxúapilake (Fifty)" by Wendy Red Star.

The exhibition takes its title from the writings of Standing Rock Sioux historian Philip J. Deloria and his colleagues, who have argued for understanding Native peoples through "the lens of futurity." The exhibition similarly considers Indigenous creativity and knowledge as active forces shaping contemporary life and the future.

Haines Gallery, a resident of Fort Mason since 2022, is dedicated to providing a platform for emerging and internationally established artists from Africa, Asia, Europe, the Middle East, North and South America.

"250 Years, Indigenous Futures" is on view now through Saturday, November 7, 2026 at Haines Gallery located in Building C, on the first floor of the Fort Mason Center for Arts and Culture. Admission is free.

Visit https://fortmason.org/event/haines-gallery-250-years-indigenous-futures/2026-09-22/ to learn more.

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SFMOMA hosts K-pop dance party tomorrow night



The event is part of SFMOMA's "Rooftop Radio" series. *Photo courtesy of San Francisco Museum of Modern Art*

By Allyson Aleksey

The San Francisco Museum of Modern Art (SFMOMA) will turn its rooftop sculpture garden into a Korean-pop dance party Thursday, October 15, featuring live performances.

"Rooftop Radio: K-pop" will take place from 5:30 to 9 p.m. in the sculpture garden on the museum's fifth floor. K-pop, short for Korean popular music, encompasses a range of musical styles but is known internationally for elaborate choreography and highly visual performances.

The genre has become a major part of American pop culture, with groups such as BTS and BLACKPINK reaching the U.S. mainstream through chart success, sold-out concerts and appearances on American television.

SFMOMA's event will feature sets by Bay Area DJs CAZU, AyumiPlease and Peter Lo, along with performances by local K-pop cover groups Groobeu, K-Pop-Up, Homeground Dance and ECLIPSE.

Sassi Fran, a San Francisco-based drag performer and co-founder of K-Pop-Up, will host the performances.

The evening also will include a photo booth, toploader decorating and activities from Kloud K-Pop, a South Bay K-pop store. Food and drinks will be available for purchase.

The 21-and-over event is part of SFMOMA's Rooftop Radio series, the museum's after-hours events combining live music, DJ sets, food, drinks, and late-access to museum galleries.

Visit https://www.sfmoma.org/event/rooftop-radio-k-pop/ to purchase tickets.

Cal Performances presents West Coast premiere of "The Head & the Load"

By Allyson Aleksey

Cal Performances will present the West Coast premiere of South African artist William Kentridge's theater production "The Head & the Load" November 12 through 15 at the Henry J. Kaiser Center for the Arts in Oakland.

The multidisciplinary work examines the history of more than 2 million Africans who fought and died during World War I.

The production combines dance, projections, speech, song, shadow play, costumes and music to explore the effects of colonialism and war.

Directed and conceived by Kentridge, the production features choreography by Gregory Maqoma and music composed by Philip Miller and Thuthuka Sibisi.

Its score combines traditional African songs, European compositions, war chants and percussion. The libretto draws on texts from anticolonial writers, Dada poets and Setswana proverbs.

The production takes its title from a Ghanaian proverb: "The head and the load are the troubles of the neck." Kentridge has described the work as an effort to document the experiences of Black participants whose contributions to the war have often been overlooked.

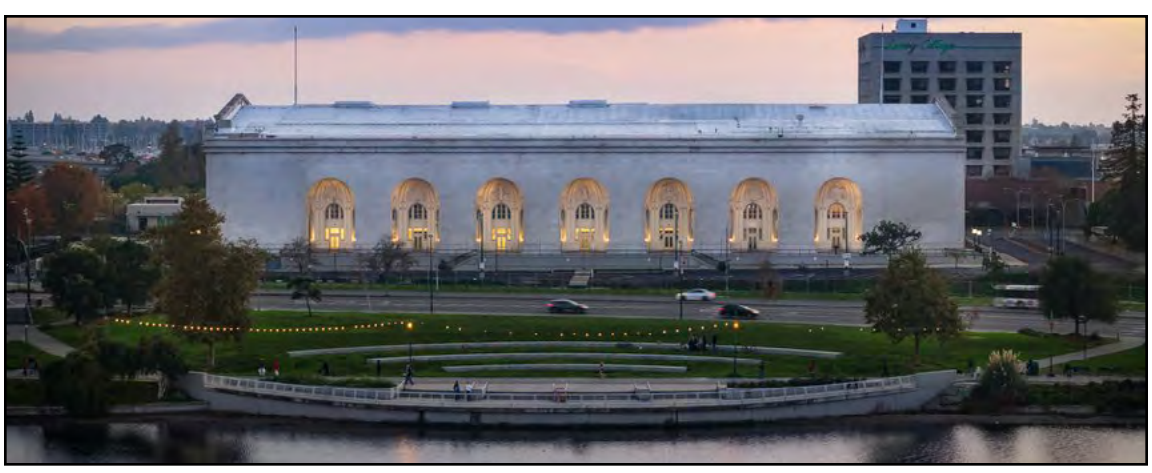
"The Head & the Load" premiered in 2018 at Tate Modern in London, followed by performances at New York City's Park Avenue Armory that year. The Oakland performances mark its West Coast premiere. A 180-foot stage will be constructed in the Kaiser Center's arena to accommodate the production.

The performances also launch a five-season Cal Performances initiative to present a different interdisciplinary work by Kentridge each season. The organization previously presented his "Sibyl" in 2023 and "The Great Yes, The Great No" in 2025.

Kentridge will participate in a free pre-performance conversation with Debarati Sanyal, director of UC Berkeley's Center for Interdisciplinary Critical Inquiry, from 6 to 7 p.m. November 13. The discussion will address the production's historical context and its relationship to the season's Illuminations theme. The event is free to ticket holders for that evening's performance.

Performances are scheduled for 7:30 p.m. November 12-14 and 3 p.m. November 15 at the Henry J. Kaiser Center for the Arts, 10 10th St., Oakland.

Tickets are available at calperformances.org or by calling the box office at 510-642-9988.



Henry J. Kaiser Center for the Arts in Oakland. *Photo by Scott Hergis*

San Francisco Symphony to present family concert October 24

By Allyson Aleksey

The San Francisco Symphony will perform a family-friendly program on October 24, welcoming parents and caregivers with young children and offering families an introduction to live orchestral music.

The 2 p.m. performance will be led by Daniel Bartholomew-Poyser, the orchestra's resident conductor of engagement and education. The program includes selections from Brook Green Suite, Peter and the Wolf, The Carnival of the Animals, Tale of the Tsar Sultan and more.

The concert series is designed for children ages 5 to 12, with interactive performances intended to encourage musical curiosity and introduce young listeners to classical music.

The Symphony's family programs offer opportunities for audiences to learn about orchestral music and the instruments and musicians that bring it to life. The series is part of the orchestra's broader educational programming for Bay Area families.

The October 24 concert is one of two "Music for Families" performances scheduled for the 2026-27 season. The second is set for May 15.

The performance will take place at Davies Symphony Hall, 201 Van Ness Ave., San Francisco. Children's tickets are half-price. Tickets and additional information are available at sfsymphony.org.



The event is part of the Symphony's Music for Families concert series. *Photo courtesy of San Francisco Symphony*

OMCA celebrates Dia de los Muertos October 25



Celebrate Dia de los Muertos at OMCA with music, dance, food and art. *Photo courtesy of OMCA*

By Allyson Aleksey

The Oakland Museum of California (OMCA) will host its 32nd annual Día de los Muertos Community Celebration from 11 a.m. to 4 p.m. October 25, featuring music, dance, art, food and community-created altars honoring the dead.

The event will include an opening procession, traditional and contemporary ofrendas, or offering altars, along with hands-on crafts, performances, demonstrations and an artisanal market. A formal welcome is scheduled for noon.

A special ofrenda, "Sanando Corazones, Healing Hearts," is on view at the museum now through November 29. Created by members of OMCA's volunteer Día de los Muertos Committee, the installation uses the heart as a symbol of love, remembrance and support for East Bay families who have lost loved ones, as well as those affected by natural disasters and warfare.

"Though our ofrendas to our dead traditionally contain items that represent spirituality, love, and life experiences, we chose to add the image of a heart as a symbol to express our heartfelt sadness and support to all East Bay families who have experienced the loss of a loved one," the OMCA Día de los Muertos Ofrenda Installation Subcommittee wrote in a press release.

The subcommittee also dedicates this year's ofrenda "to all who died this year due to the disasters created by nature and warfare."

Visitors may bring picnic blankets, low-back lawn chairs, sun protection, and layers or a light jacket to help stay comfortable throughout the celebration.

Guests are also welcome to bring their own food and non-alcoholic beverages to enjoy during the day. Food and beverages will be available for purchase.

Tickets are available at museumca.org.



The lecture covers California's native bee species.

Ruth Bancroft Garden hosts gardening for native bees lecture November 4

By Allyson Aleksey

The Ruth Bancroft Garden in Walnut Creek will host a presentation on creating bee-friendly gardens Wednesday, November 4, led by Claudia Cruse of UC Berkeley's Urban Bee Lab.

The 11 a.m. to noon program, "Gardening for Native Bees," will cover California's native bee species, the plants they prefer and ways to create gardens that provide food and habitat throughout the year.

The Urban Bee Lab at UC Berkeley has studied bee diversity and relationships between bees and plants across California since 1987. Its research has identified about 90 bee species in East Bay residential areas, most of them native to the state, according to the garden's event description. The lab also has developed an experimental bee garden at UC Berkeley to demonstrate how residential landscapes can support native bees and other pollinators.

The program will take place at the Ruth Bancroft Garden, a nonprofit botanical garden and nursery at 1552 Bancroft Road. The 3.5-acre garden is known for its collection of drought-tolerant plants, including cacti, succulents, aloes and agaves, and offers educational programs, tours and gardening resources.

Registration is available at ruthbancroftgarden.org.

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First Mondays Reading Group discusses Freezing Order

By Lois Price

The First Mondays Reading Group met on Monday, October 5 in the Community Hall to discuss their September book, Freezing Order, by Bill Browder. There was an excellent turnout of 21 readers, including two new participants for the conversation.

Freezing Order: A True Story of Money Laundering, Murder, and Surviving Vladimir Putin's Wrath is a 2022 memoir by financier and activist Bill Browder. The book picks up after Browder's previous bestseller, Red Notice, and follows the 2009 prison death of Browder's Russian lawyer, Sergei Magnitsky. Magnitsky was tortured and killed after uncovering a $230 million state tax refund fraud scheme in Russia. Browder and his investigative team tracked the stolen funds as they moved out of Russia through Cyprus, the Baltics, Western Europe, and the Americas. The investigation revealed that Russian President Vladimir Putin was a primary financial beneficiary of the laundered funds.

As international law enforcement agencies began freezing the tracked assets, Putin and his associates targeted Browder. He faced international process servers, honey traps, Interpol arrest warrants, murdered allies, and intense lobbying by high-profile Western lawyers and politicians hired to undermine him. The book argues that Browder's relentless campaign to expose Putin's hidden wealth directly motivated the Kremlin's interference in the 2016 U.S. presidential election.

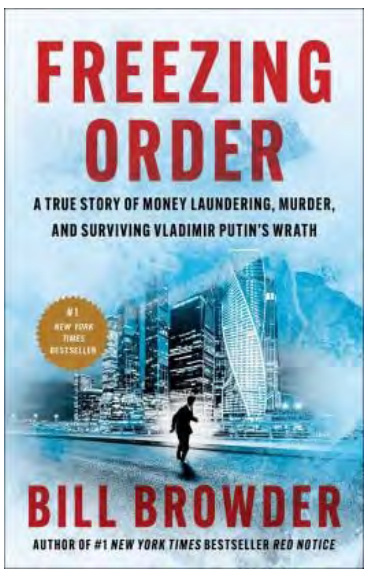
When the Piedmont reading group did a "thumbs up, thumbs down, thumbs sideways" vote on how they felt about the book. Many in the group gave an enthusiastic "thumbs up," a handful gave "thumbs sideways," and one gave a "thumbs down." Then two people who liked the book shared what they liked, followed by two who thought it was just so-so. Our lone thumbs-down voter shared his thoughts later in the meeting.

The readers appreciated the good vs. evil in the book. It was a superb real-life crime thriller. They found the legal maneuvering interesting. They agreed that Browder's work was important and felt he was ethically motivated. They were surprised that former US Congressman and Oakland Mayor Ron Dellums was mentioned.

They also felt that, given the complexity of the financial issues, Browder had to "dumb down" his writing for readers to understand what was happening. It was quite frightening, and the focus on the early Trump years was fascinating. They also wondered about the relationship to our oligarchs (i.e., the tech bros). Some readers felt the book was padded with information they didn't need. There was also some confusion about who the bad guy was and who the good guy was.

Some members of the group were surprised that John Moscow, a lawyer who turned on Browder and went with the Putin team, hasn't been disbarred. The group was wondering what really happened at a Trump Tower meeting with the Russians.

One member of our group who worked in Russia as a privatization and economic advisor felt Browder's first book was more accurate. She also shared the saying, "An optimist is someone who thinks he can do business in Russia."



Freezing Order by Bill Browder

The lone thumbs-down voter thought the book should have been shorter and focused on the main subject more. He felt the book was poorly edited. A conclusion from the discussion was that "It is happening here! It is happening everywhere."

The group had previously selected The Correspondent by Virginia Evans for November and All Creatures Great and Small by James Herriot for December. The group then voted on their January 2027 selection. Bob Hall presented three fiction books, and Out Stealing Horses by Per Petterson was the clear winner. After next month's November meeting, everyone is invited to stay and discuss how the discussions are being conducted and how they might be improved.

The First Mondays Reading Group will meet at the Community Hall for their next discussion on November 2 at 1:30 p.m. New readers are welcome. There is no fee to participate. Register at https://bit.ly/3R86PP4.

I Dug Digger

Bombed at the box office, brilliant on the big screen

By Greg Aleksey

Early in Digger, the title character Digger Rockwell, a wealthy and bombastic oil tycoon played by Tom Cruise, recounts his granddaddy's advice: any fool can hit a home run, but it takes real talent to hit a triple. The line comes back around in the film's final act, but it works just as well as a description of the movie itself. At a time when Hollywood plays it safe with sequels, superheroes, and established IP, everyone behind Digger passed on trying to launch that home run and went for a triple.

Did the gamble pay off? Warner Bros. certainly bet that it would. The studio greenlit an original film from Alejandro G. Iñárritu about one of the most powerful men in the world on a frantic mission to save humanity from a disaster he inadvertently unleashed, starring ageless A-lister Tom Cruise, with a reported budget of $160 to $180 million. That is a staggering sum for a movie with a wholly original idea. But audiences haven't shown up; Digger grossed a paltry $20 million worldwide in its opening weekend, and with industry estimates putting its losses at $200 million or more, it is on track to become one of the biggest box office bombs of all time.

So why did it fail? Well, it wasn't because of the direction or the acting. Iñárritu, who won back-to-back Best Director Oscars for Birdman and The Revenant, puts his talent (and the budget) on full display in the gorgeous sets, beautiful cinematography, and overall pacing of the film. The cast, including Riz Ahmed as a skittish scientist and John Goodman as a terminally ill U.S. president, turns in earnest, memorable performances. And in the final act, Cruise delivers a 10-minute monologue in a single unbroken take that plays like a cross between Gordon Gekko's "greed is good" and Col. Nathan R. Jessep's "you need me on that wall" speech from A Few Good Men. It is Digger's own shot at that triple his granddaddy talked about, and it is a reminder that when he isn't sprinting toward danger or hanging off the side of

See Digger on page 25





Welcome to the Piedmont Center for the Arts

Weekends through November 1, 11:00 a.m. – 2:00 p.m.
Oakland Art Association Gallery Show
Oakland Art Association presents "Hopes and Dreams," a curated show of everyone's most precious and intimate desires for the future. It can be a dream vacation, a dream come true, or a dream for the future of the world or just your part of it. OAA is a nonprofit group of artists, photographers, and art supporters in Alameda and Contra Costa counties. Free and open to all! Gallery open Saturdays and Sundays from 11 a.m. to 2 p.m. For more information, see www.oaklandart.org.

Friday, October 16, 7:00 p.m.
String, Skin, & Breath Band Concert
String, Skin, & Breath creates contemporary chamber music rooted in global traditions. Drawing from Latin and North African modes, Ethio-jazz, desert blues, and global folk traditions, the ensemble weaves hypnotic rhythms, spacious improvisation, and rich acoustic textures into performances that move between meditative stillness and intricate rhythmic interplay. The band includes Uzbek-American cellist Misha Khalikulov, Latin Grammy-nominated multi-instrumentalist Daniel Riera, percussionist/educator Aaron Kierbel, and Tunisian qanun virtuoso Arslen Metouii. Tickets available at https://www.ticketsignup.io/Band.

Saturday, October 17, 7:30 p.m.
Land's End Folk Ensemble Concert
Land's End Folk Ensemble Concert
Newly minted Land's End Folk Ensemble is a collaboration of Bay Area classical musicians exploring American and British Isles folk music. With expertise honed in the symphony hall and on the opera stage, the ensemble combines the precision of orchestral playing with the spontaneity of folk traditions. Participating musicians include tenor Chris Oglesby, soprano Rachel Cooke, pianist Karen Hutchinson, violinist Michael Long, cellist Vicky Ehrlich, violist Paul Ehrlich, and oboist Janet Archibald. Advance tickets are at https://www.ticketsignup.io/LEFE.

Sunday, October 25, 4:00 p.m.
Festival Opera Salon Series
Acclaimed sopranos Aura Veruni and Lila Khazoum are joined by pianist Daniel Lockert to perform diabolical scenes from Idomeneo, Macbeth, The Magic Flute, Anna Bolena, Hamlet, and Lucia di Lammermoor, with costumes by designer Marina Polakoff. Just in time for Halloween, come in costume if you like, and witness all of opera's great mad scenes in one evening! Advance tickets are at https://tinyurl.com/FestivalSalon2.

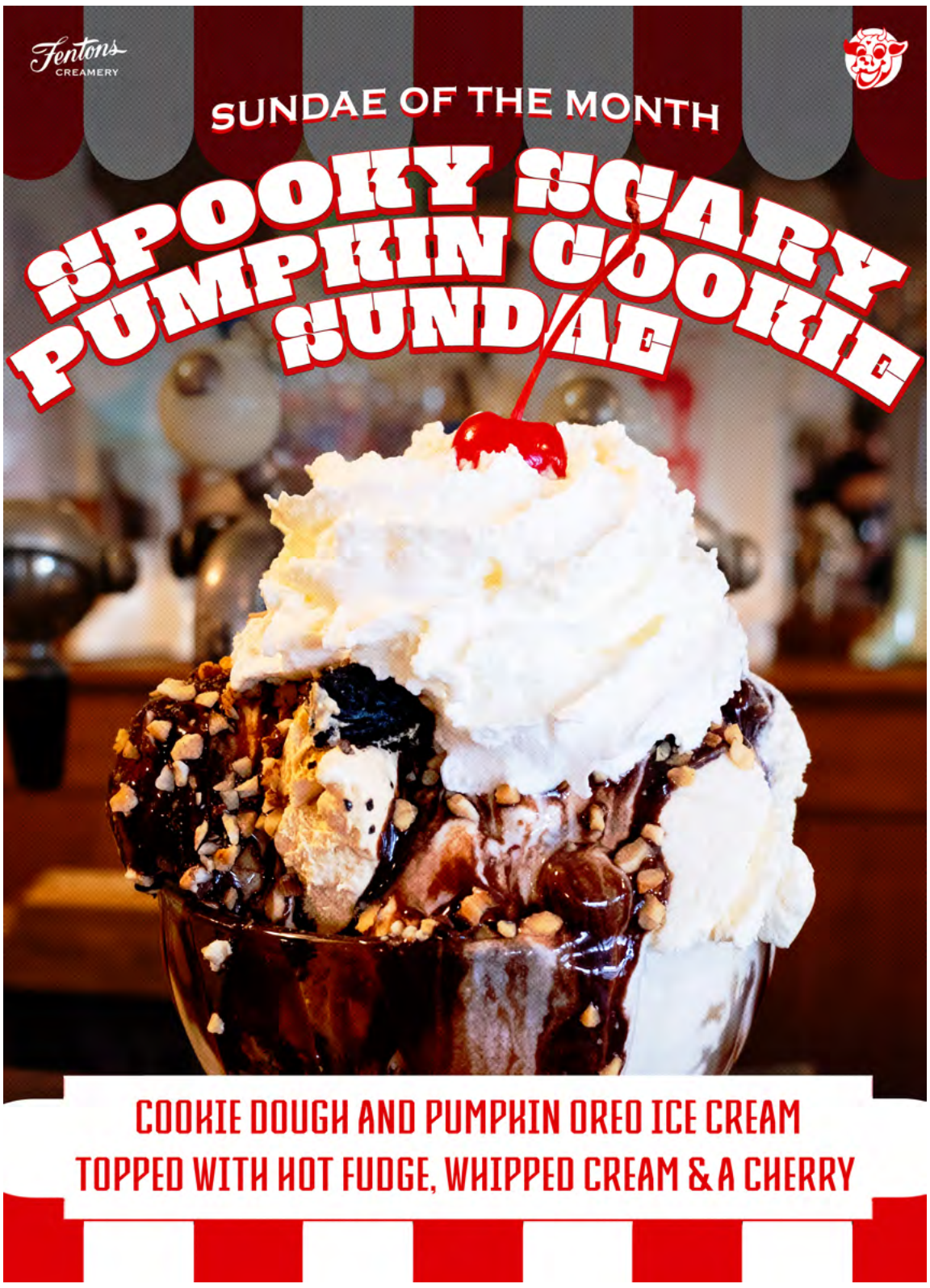
Friday, November 6, 5:00–8:00 p.m.
Artist's Opening Reception
Artist and art historian Michael Stehr returns to Piedmont Center for the Arts with Falling for the Rising Sun, a new collection inspired by a recent fall trip to Japan that gave him new architectural silhouettes, blasts of vivid color, and a sea of friendly faces. The exhibit includes 28 new paintings of Japan, Rome, and Paris, some on a larger scale than is customary for Michael. Open gallery hours are Saturdays and Sundays from 11 a.m. to 2 p.m. through November 29.

Saturday, November 7, 3:30 p.m.
Stravinsky and Rachmaninoff
Sixteen pianists, mostly from the Bay Area with guests from Toronto, will perform solo and duet piano works by these two Russian composers in two sets, at 3:30 and 4:30 p.m. Many are top prize winners in international competitions for amateur pianists. Producer Dr. Gwendolyn Mok, a renowned Bay Area pianist and piano educator, will give the net proceeds to a major international charity, as she did after last year's sold-out Ravel event. Advance tickets are at https://www.ticketsignup.io/Mokpiano.

Sunday, November 8, 4:00 p.m.
Piedmont Chamber Orchestra
Join our resident volunteer orchestra for Portraits & Poetry: Musical Gems for Winds and Strings, an afternoon of rarely performed works including Bartók's Dances of Transylvania, Enescu's Dixtour for Double Wind Quintet, and Louise Farrenc's Symphony No. 3. This popular ensemble fills the house quickly, so reserve your free seats early on Eventbrite at https://www.eventbrite.com/e/2002984140483

Wednesday, November 11, 7:00 p.m.
Trio Solano Bach Concert
Founded during the 2020 pandemic shutdown, Trio Solano performs traditional and new string trio repertoire throughout the Bay Area and frequently teams up with pianist Miles Graber. The trio received a grant from InterMusic SF in 2021 and a Silver Medal from Global Music Awards in 2022. Founding member Dan Flanagan is concertmaster of the Sacramento Philharmonic and Opera and teaches violin at UC Berkeley. He performs on a historic 1840 J.B. Vuillaume violin. Tickets will be available soon.

Saturday, November 14, 5:00 p.m.
Voci Women's Vocal Ensemble
Voci, a 20- to 24-voice treble choir, has been exciting Bay Area audiences for more than 35 years and loves to champion women composers. Its fall program, Launch into the Light, explores themes of light through choral works inspired by the luminous paintings of J.M.W. Turner, with projections of his masterpieces during the performance. Buy tickets at https://www.eventbrite.com/e/1991952076282.







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Features

Walking on Wednesday

Wednesday Walkers honor Piedmont's World Wars fallen heroes

By Dick Carter

It was another warm Piedmont day on Oct. 7 when 44 members of the Piedmont Recreation Department's Walking on Wednesdays group and three of their K-9 best friends gathered at the Exedra for their weekly walk. Piedmont Recreation Commissioner Nancy Beninati and Solene Francois, who is from France and working in Piedmont this year, walked with the group for the first time.

Sherry Jacobs led the walk. Her theme was "Piedmont WWI Fallen Heroes." Seven young Piedmont men were killed in World War I, and Sherry wanted the group to see where they lived and remember them.

Sherry started off by leading the walkers up Mountain Avenue to 21 Dormidera Ave., where Thomas Edward Graves lived with his parents. Graves, a U.S. Army lieutenant, was 23 years old and an aviation instructor in Washington, D.C., when his airplane crashed during a preliminary test.

The group then went over to Vista Avenue and the Piedmont Veterans Memorial Building. The city's original marble World War I Memorial sits underneath a set of tall redwood trees to the right of the building's entrance.

The memorial was designed by architect Albert Farr and dedicated on Armistice Day, Nov. 11, 1921. The names inscribed on it are Egbert William Beach, Henry Augustus Butters, Otto Julius Carlsen, Hunter McClure, Frank Jay Field, Thomas Edward Graves, and Carl Castlemayne Jones. It originally stood in a grove of redwood trees east of Piedmont's commercial center, where Memorial Day observances were held, and California Gov. Earl Warren visited it on Armistice Day in 1943. It was most likely moved to its present spot when the Veterans Building was built in 1953.

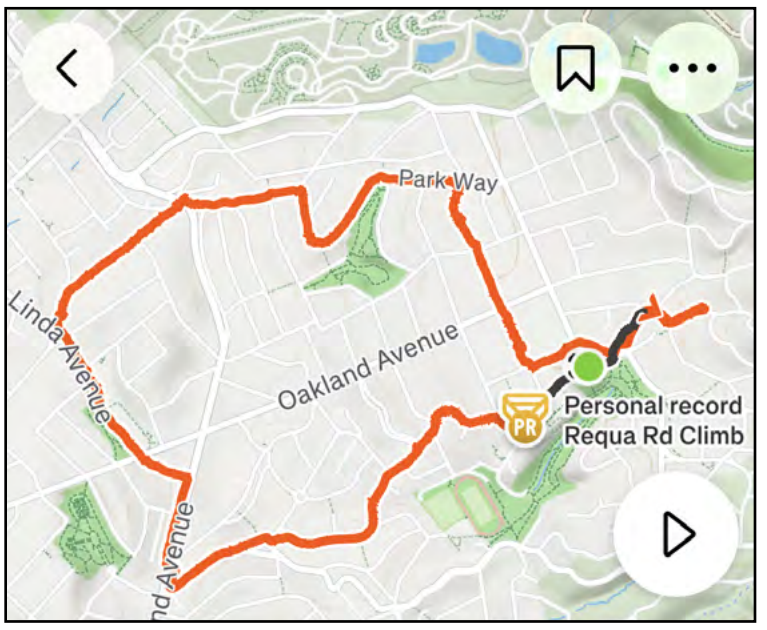
Up the steps to the building's entrance is an Honor Roll with the names of all the service members from Piedmont who lost their lives in our country's four major 20th-century conflicts: the seven men from World War I, 50 from World War II and six from the Korean War. Six more from the Vietnam War were later added to the plaque.

The walkers noted how large Piedmont's World War II loss was. The 50 young men were about 0.51% of the city's 1940 population of 9,866, compared with 0.31% nationally, or about one in 20 of Piedmont's fighting-age men.

The walkers took their group photo in front of the World War I Memorial and then went down to Bonita Avenue and up to 323 and 319 Bonita Ave., the homes of Henry Augustus Butters' family members. Butters was a second lieutenant in the British Army and was killed during the Battle of the Somme on Aug. 31, 1916. He was 24. Unlike the other men on Piedmont's memorial, he served in the British Army rather than with American forces, and he died before the United States entered the war in April 1917.

The group continued up Bonita to 128 Bonita Ave., the home of Hunter McClure of the U.S. Army, who lived in Piedmont with his aunt, Mrs. G. H. Harris. A November 1921 Oakland Tribune account said he was killed in the Argonne on Sept. 26, 1918, the opening day of the Meuse-Argonne Offensive.

The walkers then made their way to 906 Rose Ave., the home of Mr. and Mrs. Fred Jones, whose son, Carl Castlemayne Jones of the U.S. Army, was 26 years old when he was killed in the Argonne on Sept. 27, 1918, as American troops attacked heavily defended German positions.



Route map

The last stop on Sherry's tour was Beach Elementary School on Linda Avenue. The school was built in 1913 as the Lake Avenue School and was renamed in 1918 for 2nd Lt. Egbert W. Beach of the U.S. Army. Beach was born in San Francisco, grew up in Piedmont and graduated from Oakland High School in 1909 and the University of California, Berkeley, in 1916. He was killed on April 27, 1918, by a German artillery shell near Villers-Tournelle, France, while helping locate trenches for an infantry working party. He was 29 years old. Sadly, orders had been issued two days earlier for him to return to the United States to train new troops, but the orders came too late. He is buried at Somme American Cemetery in Bony, France. He is also remembered as the first California officer killed on foreign soil during the war. The walkers plan to visit his family home at 111 Sunnyside Ave. at a later date.

It was a hot morning, and time for the group to return to the Exedra. For time and distance reasons, they did not visit the family homes of the other two men on the memorial. Otto Julius Carlsen was killed in the Meuse-Argonne campaign on Sept. 26, 1918, and was buried in Oakland in 1921. Frank Jay Field died of influenza on Sept. 21, 1918, while awaiting assignment to a ship in New London, Connecticut.

These men and all the others from Piedmont who lost their lives fighting in our country's wars should be remembered. Last Wednesday, thanks to Sherry Jacobs, they were remembered by the Wednesday walkers.

Walking on Wednesday meets weekly at 10:30 a.m. at the Exedra. The program is free and open to the public. Registration with the Piedmont Recreation Department is required at https://tinyurl.com/3ethkehu.



The Walking on Wednesdays group gathers at the Piedmont World War I Memorial on Oct. 7. Among those participating were Mike Henn, Nancy Henn with K-9 best friend Roger, Denny McGee, Juliane Jacqueline, Irene Thompson, Bern Schild, Christine Cumbelich, Kristin Howard, Nancy DeRoche with K-9 best friend Pepper, Adam Hundt, Quincy Dong, Jim Kellogg, Marion Lim Yankowitz, Jack Fischrup with K-9 best friend Kojak, Marianne Jakus, Mark Davis, Debbie Powell, Mike Gallant, Cathy Laymon, Lisa Euphrat, Caskey Weston, Max Becker, Judy Love, Melba Yee, Helne Dong, Noemi Alvarado, Lois Price, Audrey Sung, Peggy Shultz, Bill Ahern, Joyce Ahern, Mary Carter, Chuck Oraftik, Dave DeRoche, Judy Sokoloff, Albert Chen, Rick Eigenbrode, Pat Nicholas, Rich Harmes, Ken Hubbert, Al Chen with K-9 best friend Sherlock, Dick Carter, Piedmont Recreation Commissioner Nancy Beninati and Solene Francois.



The Wine Corner

Jura: France's Small Wine Region with a Distinctive Character

Part One

By Pierre DuMont

Tucked between Burgundy and the Swiss border in eastern France, the Jura wine region is one of the country's smallest and most distinctive wine-producing areas. Its rolling hills, limestone-rich soils and cool continental climate provide the setting for wines that have increasingly captured the attention of sommeliers, collectors and adventurous drinkers.

Stretching along the foothills of the Jura Mountains, the region is home to picturesque villages, historic cellars and vineyards that reflect centuries of winemaking tradition. Its principal wine towns include Arbois, Château-Chalon and L'Étoile, each offering a glimpse into the region's rich cultural heritage.

Jura is perhaps best known for vin jaune, or "yellow wine," an unusual specialty made predominantly from the Savagnin grape. After fermentation, the wine ages for at least six years and three months in barrels without being topped up, allowing a protective veil of yeast to develop. The result is a complex, golden wine with distinctive notes of walnuts, spices and dried fruit.

Yet Jura's appeal extends well beyond this celebrated style. Winemakers produce fresh, mineral-driven whites from Chardonnay and Savagnin, elegant reds from Poulsard and Trousseau, and Crémant du Jura, a traditional-method sparkling wine. The region is also renowned for vin de paille, a luscious, sweet wine made from grapes dried before fermentation.

Another local treasure is the traditional oxidative wine style, which develops nutty, savory flavors through prolonged exposure to oxygen. Alongside these historic techniques, a new generation of growers is embracing organic and biodynamic viticulture, bringing renewed international attention to Jura.

The region's gastronomy is equally compelling. Local wines pair naturally with Comté, the celebrated mountain cheese, as well as freshwater fish, poultry, fondue and creamy regional dishes.

Although Jura remains relatively under the radar compared with neighboring Burgundy, its individuality is precisely its strength. For travelers seeking authentic French wine culture, unspoiled landscapes and bottles with a compelling sense of place, Jura offers a rewarding discovery.



Chateau Chalon has been named one of the most beautiful villages in France

Three Great Estates

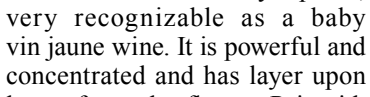
Last month I had the opportunity to spend a week wine tasting in the Jura region. Among the most compelling producers I visited are Domaine de Montbourgeau, Domaine Macle, and Domaine Berthet-Bondet, three estates united by a commitment to expressing the region's remarkable character.

At Domaine de Montbourgeau, the story begins in 1920, when Victor Gros acquired the property at L'Étoile. Now in the hands of the fourth generation of the family, we were hosted by Cesar Dereaux who now runs the estate in conjunction with his brother. The estate has built its reputation on Chardonnay and Savagnin grown across approximately 11 hectares. Its wines capture the distinctive personality of L'Étoile, an appellation named for the star-shaped fossils found in its limestone and marl soils. Alongside fresh, elegant whites, the Domaine produces wines aged under a protective veil of yeast, as well as the region's prized Vin Jaune. The result is a range that balances freshness, mineral precision and the savory complexity for which Jura is celebrated.

Further south, Domaine Macle has become synonymous with Château-Chalon, the appellation responsible for some of France's most distinctive white wines. Laurent Macle's daughter Carmen gave us the tour and conducted the tasting. The Macle family is particularly associated with traditional Savagnin-based wines matured under voile, a natural layer of yeast that develops on the wine's surface during ageing. This slow process creates extraordinary complexity, bringing aromas and flavors of walnuts, dried fruit, spice and an unmistakable savory depth. Their Château-Chalon is a benchmark expression of the style, demonstrating how patience and careful cellar work can transform a local grape into a wine of remarkable longevity.

Domaine Berthet-Bondet, also based in Château-Chalon, offers another compelling interpretation of the Jura. Established by Jean and Chantal Berthet-Bondet in 1985, the estate combines traditional winemaking with a commitment to organic viticulture. Now led by their daughter Hélène, who conducted the generous tasting, it produces a broad selection of wines, including Château-Chalon, Côtes du Jura whites and reds, Crémant du Jura, and Vin de Paille. Its portfolio highlights the versatility of local varieties, from the nutty intensity of Savagnin aged under voile to the more direct, fruit-driven character of wines matured without it.

Together, these three domains illustrate the diversity and enduring appeal of Jura wine. In a world increasingly drawn to distinctive, place-driven bottles, their wines offer something genuinely individual: a taste of a region where time, tradition and terroir remain inseparable.



This wine spends three years aging in oak barrels.

Favorite Wines

- **Montbourgeau Cremant du Jura**

At just 13 euros a bottle this is an incredible bargain. A fresh nose of citrus and flowers is followed by vibrant lemon/lime fruit, profuse tiny bubbles, and a long bone-dry finish. The perfect aperitif.

- **2022 Montbourgeau L'Etoile Savagnin**

While Montbourgeau makes some lovely fresh modern style wines called "Ouilles" I found myself more intrigued by the "sous voile" wines that are aged for many years in barrels that are not topped up. This wine was aged for 42 months and has a golden color and a nose of walnuts and curry spices, very recognizable as a baby vin jaune wine. It is powerful and concentrated and has layer upon layer of complex flavors. Pair with an aged Comte cheese or walnuts.

- **2017 Macle Chateau Chalon**

Opening with a hauntingly complex nose that combines fino sherry and honeysuckle, the wine has great freshness with pristine aromas and flavors, beautiful texture and a pungency and tasty saltiness that gives it a long satisfying finish. This complex masterpiece is built to last for decades if not a century in the cellar.

- **NV Macle Macvin**

Macvin is a beverage unique to the Jura. This one is made by mixing 2/3 Chardonnay and 1/3 Marc, a liquor made from the grape skins and pips. You get a fortified wine with 17% alcohol and a mellow sweetly fruity taste. The French drink it over ice as an aperitif and I must say I highly approve.

- **2022 Berthet-Bondet Tradition**

This is a blend of 70% Chardonnay and 30% Savagnin aged "Sous Voile" under the veil of yeast for three years. It is exhilarating with notes of toasted bread and subtle smokiness, with superb balance, all subtleness, and a salty twist in the finish. This is the kind of wine where if you leave a half bottle open for a few days when you return it is even more complex and compelling.

- **2020 Berthet-Bondet Savagnin**

My favorite wine from this producer, as it has more volume, clout and complexity than the very good Tradition. Matured for three years under the flor veil it has notes of aromatic herbs, citrus, walnuts, curry and mushrooms with pungent flavors and a pleasant touch of bitterness on the finish. This powerful, layered wine will improve for decades and decades in the cellar. The perfect partner to fondue or raclette.



Helene is now in charge of Berthet-Bondet



Cesar Dereaux and his brother run Domaine Montbourgeau.



A centuries old house in Chateau Chalon is home to Domaine Macle

Student Board Members bring new perspectives

By Julia Stokes

Alongside the five members of the Piedmont Board of Education sit student representatives, providing a voice for the student body where decisions are made. This fall, those two students are PHS junior Diego Branneria and MHS junior Corinne Minor.

"I applied because I thought it'd be a really good opportunity to get more involved with our community, and I was also curious how the Board works," Minor said. "I thought it was a good opportunity for me to branch out and learn how to speak in front of a lot of people."

According to the PUSD Website, Student Board members are elected in a process that involves an initial application screening, and once the Board has chosen candidates, a student election.

"I applied because I think it's super important, especially in Piedmont, that we hold our decision makers accountable," Branneria said. "I think we also are a really unique district where we have a ton of strength, but there are also a lot of ways that we can better support our students."

The role of Student Board members involves participation in discussions at Board Meetings and updating the Board on happenings at Piedmont schools. The Student Board members vote on issues but their votes are not counted, Minor said.

"I really hope student board members can get a position to actually vote and have our votes be counted, because I know they do that in Berkeley and Oakland, but not in Piedmont yet," Minor said.

Branneria said that one of the main issues he sees with Piedmont schools right now is the emphasis on test scores and academic performance over student well-being.

"I think we need to do a better job making sure that Piedmont kids are being set up for success, not just to take the SAT once they get into high school, but to actually enjoy their experience and learn things that they really want to learn about," Branneria said. "We should be prioritizing student well-being over academic excellence, because we can do both."

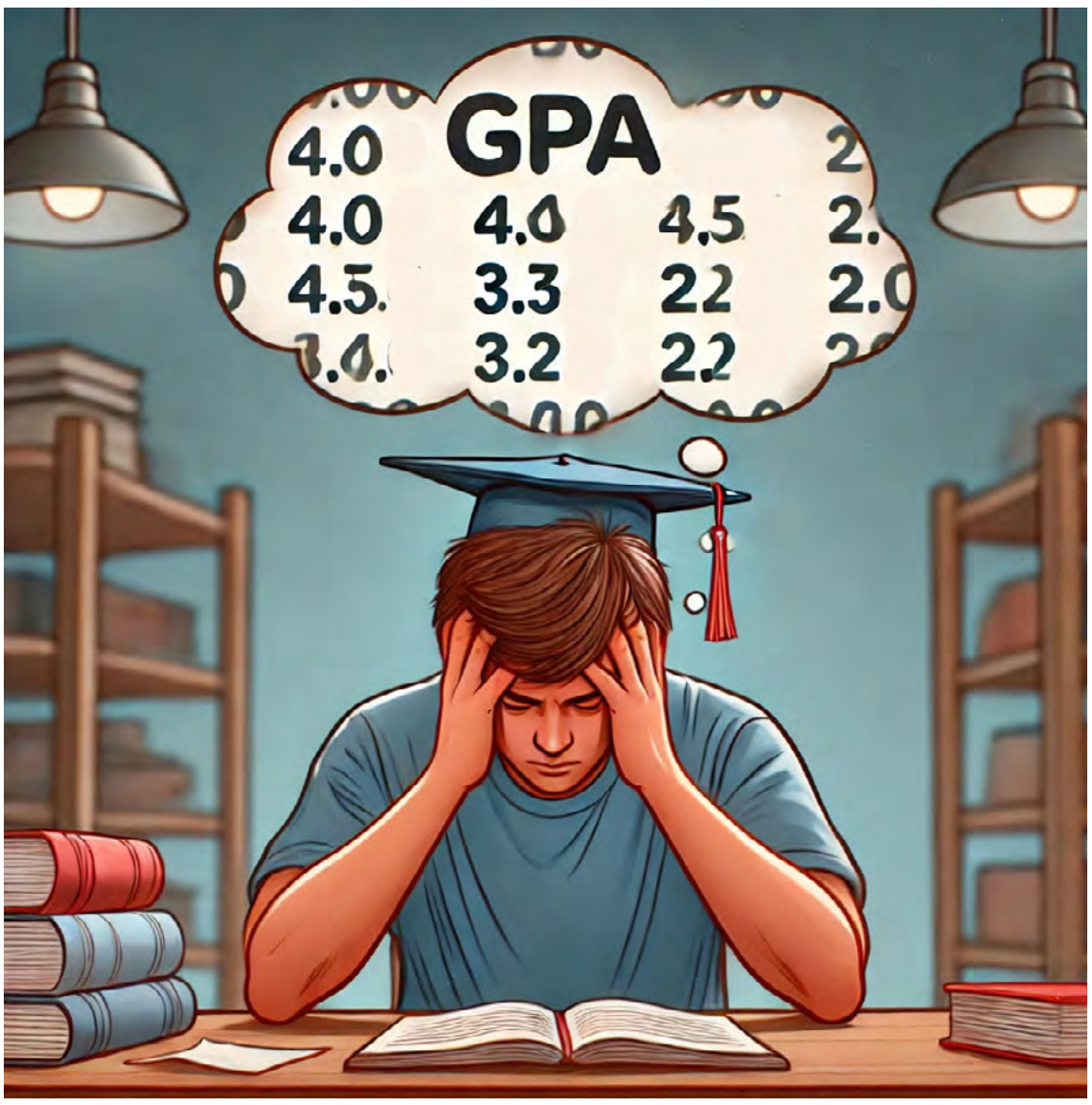
Branneria also said he thinks teacher salaries in Piedmont can be improved.

"I hope that we can make progress in supporting our teachers more, because I don't think that the community understands that Piedmont does not have a competitive teacher salary," Branneria said. "We've had five chemistry teachers in the past six years. This isn't a coincidence."

Minor and Branneria will serve on the School Board for just the fall semester, but plan to continue to stay involved after their time on the Board.

"There are a lot of things that need work," Branneria said. "There's more than just 'Piedmont is a great school district.' Even though it is."

Julia Stokes is a junior at Piedmont High School and a student writer intern for the Piedmont Post.



The average high school GPA in the U.S. rose from 2.6 in 1985 to 3.1 in 2020, according to the National Education Society

Graphic courtesy of The Plaid Press

The Weighted Class Debate

By Mira Sen

Honors English was recently added to Piedmont High School's list of course offerings for sophomores, to a chorus of mixed opinions. The addition is part of a recent push to increase the presence of weighted classes in the school's curriculum. While this rigor is supposed to be an improvement to the school, its effects on students remain unclear.

As of today, most students are critical of the addition, finding it stress-inducing and divisive. One junior at Piedmont High believes that the addition of "10th Honors English and Honors MWH is a bad decision. I know sophomores taking weighted classes, even though they technically don't have to…high achieving students will automatically feel pressured."

She speaks from a place of familiarity, as she is currently enrolled in three AP classes (AP Chem, AP US History, and AP Calculus BC). She has been able to manage her busy schedule through good study habits, but acknowledged that the options have made her feel like she needs to "take an AP in a subject to be 'good' at it." She also noted that she has found herself comparing the number of APs on her schedule to that of others.

Another junior agreed with the first student, saying that she felt encouraged to take weighted classes that she is less passionate about so that she could "be on par" with other students. A third student added that it creates "peer pressure."

In a perfect world, a student's schedule would reflect their interests. Currently, students are taking classes just because they feel like they must, stopping them from engaging with the material fully. This detracts from the reason the classes were added in the first place: creating more learning opportunities.

Some students have felt that they were able to learn more from the earlier course offerings. One said that taking the non-honors English and History classes as a sophomore was "completely fine and a very valuable experience." The same student, now taking both AP US History and Honors English in her junior year, says that while her classes are interesting, the homework is "overwhelming" and sometimes she wishes she had "more time to just think about what [she's] learning." Increasing honors offerings earlier seems to accelerate the discontentment, taking away from the value of the course rather than opening more avenues for knowledge.

Head-Royce School in Oakland has taken a different approach when it comes to rigor. After COVID, the private school completely phased out APs, and while it still has weighted honors classes, the split is only present in the STEM subjects. Additionally, the school allows seniors to build their schedules from a large list of "senior seminars." This, in the opinion of many students, allows them to follow their interests rather than outside pressure. One Head-Royce senior, Anaiah Singh, says that getting to build her schedule herself has made her feel "more fulfilled" overall.

Pressure will exist everywhere: in high school, in college, and in the workplace. However, it should feel like constructive pressure, especially for growing brains. Students should be taught to stretch themselves out of interest in their subjects, rather than the perceived opinions of peers and college admissions officers.

The current shift at Piedmont High puts students in a pressure cooker, risking dissatisfaction and higher risk of burnout. At the end of the day, the decisions of the school board and the reviews of the students themselves will determine the weighted class debate.

Mira Sen is a sophomore at Head Royce High School and a student writer intern with the Piedmont Post.

Children's Fairyland hosts Monsters Ball

Fairyland's inaugural Halloween night out for adults

Every fairytale has a villain — and for one night, they're throwing the party. Monsters' Ball invites guests 21 and older to revel on the dark side as the park they once knew is claimed by the exiled, the forgotten, and the delightfully wicked. The evening takes place on Friday, October 23, from 6 to 10 p.m. as part of Fairyland's Happily After Hours (21+) series, which reimagines the park after dark for adult audiences.

The night's offerings include:

- Costumes are encouraged,
- Cocktails & food trucks. trucks
- An open-air dance floor with music by DJ heyLove
- A haunted park and scare zone
- Spooky scenes throughout the grounds

Valid ID is required for entry. General admission tickets are available at fairyland.org/monsters-ball for $28 and $23 for Fairyland Members. Food and drinks will be available for purchase throughout the evening. A limited VIP experience, The Ghostlight Gathering, will also be available, offering priority entry, reserved seating, an open bar, and an appearance from the "Forgotten Rider". To book the Ghostlight Gathering Package, please email kelley.bartlow@fairyland.org.

Collecting photos for Where in the World

For 25 years, Piedmont residents have made sure their travels are well documented, with photos of family members reading the *Piedmont Post* in far-off places throughout the world, and some nearby.

The *Post* invites families to send photos with the *Post* from near and far for publication in *Where in the World Are We* on the back page of the paper. With people able to travel once again, there is no better time to have your photo in the *Post*.

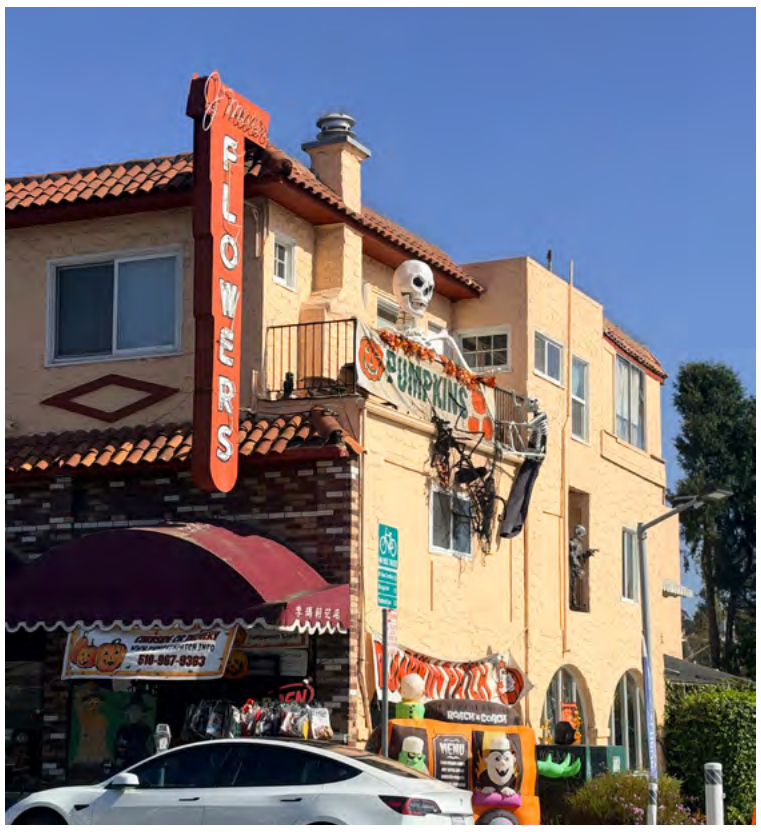
Send photos as jpg. files to: news@piedmont-post.com, and be sure to include a brief description of the location where the photo was taken.

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The Piedmont Avenue Pumpkin Patch is located in the same building as J. Miller Flowers, next to the Chevron station.

One stop Halloween shop on Piedmont Avenue

By Jay Russell

Piedmont Avenue Pumpkin Patch, located at 4414 Piedmont Avenue next to J. Miller

Flowers, is open seven days a week from 9:00 a.m. to 8:00 p.m. This year is the patch's 30th anniversary, and proprietor Jon Goldstein has a few spooky surprises up his sleeve.

Goldstein has been perfecting the on-site haunted house for 15 years. He visits Halloween conventions throughout the year to make his small twisting haunted house worth the $10 admission. It is quite scary and will skip a beat in the heart of anyone brave enough to walk through. Goldstein's three miniature dachshunds are on-site for haunted house survivors in need of emotional support.

The pumpkin patch features more than a dozen varieties of pumpkin, including Cinderellas, Tonda de Pandanas, and Turban Squash. Patrons can leisurely browse the large displays of jaw-dropping halloween decorations, accessories and costumes for sale inside the halloween store. The pumpkin patch and store are free to enter.

The outdoor pumpkin patch has multiple photography back drops for patrons to remember the moment. The Piedmont Avenue Pumpkin Patch has something for everyone and with a lively atmosphere and unique artifacts for sale.

For the crowds out on Sunday Strolls on the avenue, The Piedmont Avenue Pumpkin Patch made for a fun stop. Its ample hours of operation make anytime the right time to visit, see sample the curiosities and take home a pumpkin or costume.



Proprietor Jon Goldstein wears a Niffler hat, from the world of Harry Potter.



The Piedmont Avenue Pumpkin Patch has gourds, haunted decorations, play areas for kids, costumes and even cute cuddly puppy dogs.



The entry way to the Haunted House promises ghastly scares around every corner.



Check out the large selection of pumpkins at the Piedmont Avenue Pumpkin Patch

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▶ OPEN SUNDAY 2-4:30PM ◀

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5BR • 5BA • $4,995,000

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PPD

Continued from page 11

of injured possum. Animal taken to San Ramon Hospital for care.

9:05 p.m. Moraga Ave. Report of ebike rider doing wheelie. Subject possibly a juvenile, no pursuit.

10:33 p.m. Wildwood Ave. Hit & Run. Arrest. Report of car accident. White Infiniti QX60 SUV crashes into parked car. Lexus loses a wheel. Officers find wheel in middle or road and gouge in pavement, leading to the suspect vehicle. Suspect driver is puking. Driver arrested for DUI and taken to hospital, blood alcohol level checked at hospital.

Friday, October 9

9:10 a.m. Highland Ave. Report of BMW SUV partially blocking driveway. Driver contacted at PHS and moves car.

9:29 a.m. Bonita Ave. Report of gas-powered leaf blower. Gardener has been advised of PCO.

PICK OF THE WEEK

- Hello dear, I'm home.

Thursday, October 8

10:35 a.m. Crest Rd. 911 caller reports deer inside their home. Deer smashed through the door and is now unable to get out of the house. Deer is inside living room and kitchen area. Resident leaves front door open. Caller calls back to report deer has left the building.

Digger

Continued from page 18

an airplane like a madman, Tom Cruise is a damn good actor. He has played memorable, off-kilter characters before, in Magnolia and Tropic Thunder, and Digger Rockwell belongs in that company.

The fault isn't in the themes, either. It's in how the film was sold. The marketing did the film no favors: the initial trailers sold it as a screwball dark comedy in the vein of the Coen Brothers, built around a familiar threat of a climate catastrophe. But early in the first act, a twist, hidden by the marketing, turns the whole movie on its head. I won't spoil it here, but the film shifts from a Coen Brothers romp about runaway glaciers into a spiritual successor to Birdman, one focused on the intriguing role satire plays in the current zeitgeist.

That rug pull is gutsy and absolutely a big swing, but it is also divisive. Some will applaud the subversion and the fresh take, while others will see it as false advertising and a waste of their hard-earned time and money. I knew the twist going in and was still pleasantly surprised by how it played out over the rest of the film's 129-minute runtime.

That is the real story of Digger. It isn't a bad movie; it is a hard movie to sell. Asking a mainstream audience to buy a ticket for one film and then sit through a different one was always going to be a gamble at this price tag, and the opening weekend suggests many moviegoers either sensed the bait-and-switch or simply weren't interested in the film they ultimately got. Critics have split almost down the middle, and audiences who did turn out have been lukewarm too. I saw it on a Saturday afternoon in a nearly empty theater: seven people, including me, and two of them walked out before the ending. As the credits rolled, an older woman sighed, "Well, that's two hours I'll never get back." I couldn't have disagreed more with that sentiment.

But a big, strange, expensive swing from an Oscar-winning director and arguably still the world's most bankable movie star is increasingly rare in a multiplex dominated by sequels and superheroes, and that alone makes Digger worth seeing on the big screen, where Iñárritu's visuals land hardest. Go in knowing it isn't the movie the trailers promised. Go in for Cruise's monologue, which is worth the ticket on its own. And go soon, because a film losing this much money won't stay in theaters long. Years from now, it may well be rediscovered as a cult classic, the way box office disappointments like Blade Runner and Fight Club were. If it is, you'll be able to say you saw it on the big screen.

Digger Rockwell's granddaddy had it right. Everyone behind Digger went for that triple, then got greedy and tried to stretch it into an inside-the-park home run. The box office numbers show they were thrown out at the plate. But you have to applaud the hustle; It was a thrilling dash for home, and fun to watch them round the bases even if they ultimately never scored.

Rockridge Invites Families to Trick-or-Treat at Annual Halloween Parade



Check out the Tin Man and his companion, the Cowardly Lion.

The 34th Annual Rockridge Halloween Parade returns Sunday, October 25, from 11 a.m. to 2 p.m., inviting children, parents, and four-legged friends to dress up, trick-or-treat, and enjoy Halloween activities at more than 40 participating locations. The free, family-friendly celebration stretches along College Avenue from Broadway to Alcatraz Avenue, with local businesses offering treats, Halloween-themed activities, face painting, crafts, sales, and other fun surprises.

Families can begin their Halloween adventure at Halloween Hub #1 in the Rockridge Library parking lot, 5366 College Ave, hosted by the Rockridge Community Planning Council. The hub will offer a puppet show and crafts hosted by the Museum of Children's Art (MOCHA). Halloween Hub #2 will be at College Avenue Presbyterian Church, 5951 College Ave., and will feature family crafts, a photo booth, and entertainment.

Families are encouraged to come in costume and plan to spend the afternoon exploring Rockridge. The parade is free for everyone. Learn more about the available activities at RockridgeDistrict.com.

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Candidates' Q&A

Continued from page 1

My goal is to ensure that our police have the tools they need to keep our community safe, while carefully evaluating their effectiveness and ensuring they are used responsibly, lawfully, and with appropriate oversight.

Adam Hundt
(AdamHundt.com)

There are legitimate uses for Flock for public safety, but before voting to renew the contract, I would investigate if and how data gathered from Piedmont's Flock cameras is used. I support public safety measures, but I acknowledge residents' legitimate privacy concerns. I will ensure these concerns are addressed.

When the Piedmont City Council voted to approve Flock cameras, the intent was to monitor stolen or missing vehicles or vehicles used to commit crimes in and around the city. Piedmont's safety cameras have helped reduce crime, including larceny/theft and motor vehicle theft, which are the city's highest crime categories (based on a 5-year average, 2019-2024). Piedmont works with Flock to provide a public ALPR Transparency Portal that shares information regarding camera operations. My professional experience at technology companies is helpful in reviewing the privacy safeguards Piedmont must impose on Flock data.

If elected to Council, I will follow up on the suggestion that police department staffing be prioritized. In the 2025-2026 budget year, the city projects to be under its approved budget for regular and part-time salaries and 50% over its approved budget on overtime salaries.

Tom Ramsey, Incumbent
(Vote4TomRamsey.com)

California's anti-bias rules and the Brown Act discourage me from deciding on a vote before a public hearing, so I'll wait to review the contract and have a public discussion before answering the voting question. This topic is important, though. I support the use of cameras and ALPR technology and think of this issue in three parts:

Safety and civil liberties: Cameras and license plate reader technology help keep our town safe, but safeguarding resident privacy is non-negotiable.

Transparency: The Piedmont Police Department was the first law enforcement agency in the nation to launch an ALPR Transparency Portal. This public resource tracks data and lists each external agency that has access.

Guardrails: Our system does not use facial recognition; data is encrypted, automatically deleted on a 30-day rolling timeline, and is owned 100% by the city. State laws restrict sharing to legitimate law enforcement purposes only. While we have guardrails in place, we need to be diligent in updating our practices and policies to keep pace with technology, remain transparent, and keep the public's trust.

Bill Reichle
(ReichleForPiedmont.com)

Automatic License Plate Readers (ALPR) cameras are one tool the Piedmont Police Department uses to aid investigations. Piedmont has used this technology with success since 2014, and the current contract runs through 2028. Flock is one vendor, and other competitors offer similar ALPR technology.

Flock cameras have lately become a symbol for society's unease with our eroding sense of privacy. Smartphones and connected devices have technology that tracks our locations, conversations, communications, and consumer-spending habits, while ALPR is limited to capturing license plates. Nevertheless, the disquiet is real, and there have been alarming incidents of misuse of ALPR data from around the country. It is right to be concerned and demand oversight and accountability.

Any decision to issue or renew a contract for ALPRs would require listening to Piedmont residents to fully understand their concerns, an analysis by PPD of the cost-benefit of this tool, discussing the opportunity cost of forgoing other tools, a gap analysis of features and safeguards, and a competitive analysis to see what features competitors can offer. This analysis would need to include cybersecurity protections vendors offer to prevent and report on unauthorized access.

Sunny Bostrom-Fleming

As the person who was instrumental in inspiring the installation of these security devices, I'm acutely aware of how these devices have proven to be effective. They've apprehended individuals driving through our Piedmont streets day and night who have warrants from other cities and states for previous crimes. I am totally in favor of continuing with Flock. However, we need to review the 150 agencies receiving this sensitive information, because safeguarding personal information remains a very high priority.

We don't have enough information on the current recipients to determine who should be added or subtracted from the list already receiving our sensitive information.

The Flock collected information should be shared with law enforcement, both local and national, and certainly not for commercial purposes or by agencies that resell information. We should take a good look at increasing camera coverage in our schools, playgrounds, and parks.

The Dearing Memorial Art Project, which cost $400,000, needs camera coverage inside and out to discourage it from becoming a homeless shelter, illegal drug dispensary, toilet, a graffiti magnet, and other criminal activity.

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Piedmont Post newspaper

Routes currently available for weekly & monthly routes.
For location of delivery & details,
send an e-mail with your name & phone number.
Ideal job for middle school-age boys & girls.
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Math Pathways

Continued from page 1

and 30% without compression. If approved, next year all 6th graders will be placed into the compression class.

"The idea of 'compression for all' at the middle school has opened a rift between teachers and administration. We are otherwise on the same page with regards to the shift to AGA, the removal of compression at the high school level, and most other details of the 6th through 12th grade math pathways," said Colburn.

The district plans to provide additional Math Specialists for students in grades 6 & 7 to support the change. On the district website, compression math is said to have a volume of homework and frequency of tests approximately 33% more than the current Common Core Math 6 class.

"I'm genuinely curious what Piedmont parents will think of middle school 'compression for all' as it was a decision made without teacher or parent input," said Colburn.

The district will have to update its advice and philosophy on its website, as it read "Compression is Not for Everyone" as of last week. Other statements on the site will also have to be replaced, now that parents and students will not have the option to decide if they were ready for compression math in 6th grade.

"Echoing the advice of many math experts, the District recommends that parents carefully consider whether and when their students should choose a compression pathway. As noted above, compression is appropriate for some but not all," the district site read on October 9.

The district states these math pathway changes will "allow most students to complete Algebra I in 8th grade & Calculus in 12th grade" and that course readiness will be decided with built in "curriculum-agnostic assessments." The plan also champions flexible on-ramps and off-ramps for students, and chances for advancement during the summer.

During the October 13 meeting Board Member Max Roman said "This change might not be perfect, but I think we can all agree that the current system is not working."

The district moved to its current math pathway model in 2018, with a spilt 3-2 vote and highly opinionated community discussion. The discussion continues tonight at 7:00 p.m. in City Hall during the School Board Meeting.

New Commander

Continued from page 1

Foster, who was promoted to sergeant on August 8, has nearly two decades of law enforcement experience and began her sworn career right here in Piedmont. She then spent eight years with the San Pablo Police Department, where she served in several assignments and became the first female officer selected to the department's SWAT team.

She returned to Piedmont in October 2025. Shavies said her leadership qualities became apparent almost immediately.

"The moment that she returned, her leadership qualities were undeniable," Chief Shavies said. "We have great faith in Sergeant Foster, her ability to lead our personnel, represent this department, and continue building upon the culture of service that we expect from the Piedmont Police Department."

Speaking at the City Council meeting, Foster expressed appreciation for the recognition.

"It truly means a lot to have this moment recognized by the city and the community that we have the privilege of serving," Foster said.

With Cornell taking charge of the department's support services, including surveillance technology and records, and Foster assuming a supervisory role in patrol operations, the Piedmont Police Department has strengthened leadership across both its technical and patrol operations. Residents can learn more about the department's services on the city's website.



New Support Services Commander Jodi Cornell ith Police Chief Frederick Shavies.



Photos courtesy of the Piedmont Police Department's IG

Newly promoted Sergeant Kristina Foster with Chief Shavies.

Candidate Scorecard Week 7

All candidates support Measure GG

Candidates	Top 3 issues facing Piedmont	Top 3 infrastructure needs in Piedmont	Moraga Canyon Specific Plan	Do you support the Fire Dept. union	Flock Safety concerns
Nancy Beninati	Public Safety, Good Governance, Preserving Community and Sustainability	Maintaining streets and sidewalks, upgrading stormwater systems, and modernizing public facilities	Delivers the required affordable housing, is financially and legally sound, and enhances the community.	Supports fair compensation while also making sure that any agreement is financially sustainable and treats all employees fairly.	ALPRs can be a valuable tool for law enforcement, but technology that collects information about people moving through our community requires appropriate oversight, accountability, and transparency.
Adam Hundt	Affordable electrification and energy-efficient home upgrades, building new homes, and raising city revenue	Mitigating risk from hazards that could affect residents' housing, and maintaining roads and bike pathways	Ensure noise levels are controlled in compliance with wildfire safety protocols, and preserve Coaches Field and the Corporation Yard.	The City Council should present a plan for the police and fire departments. Maintain services in a way that is fair to the union members and ensures that the departments are adequately funded.	Before voting to renew the contract, Hundt would investigate if and how data gathered from Piedmont's Flock cameras is used. He supports public safety measures, but acknowledges residents' legitimate privacy concerns.
Tom Ramsey (*Incumbent*)	Community safety, fiscal responsibility, and maintaining the beauty of our town	Sewers and storm drains, pavement management, and aging civic buildings	Needs to see a clear commitment to the vision our community developed through numerous public workshops, commission reviews, and formal hearings.	Committed to continuing transparent, good-faith dialogue to reach a sustainable agreement that is both fair to all employees and fiscally responsible to the community.	Supports the use of cameras and ALPR technology. Piedmont's current system under Ramsey does not use facial recognition; data is encrypted and automatically deleted on a 30-day rolling timeline, and is owned 100% by the city.
Bill Reichle	Moraga Canyon housing, sustainability, and updating century-old city facilities	Street paving, ADA upgrades, and updating older city buildings.	Focused on public safety, traffic circulation, pedestrian and bicycle safety, and wildfire mitigation.	Would use Measure GG revenue to help fund the fire department and help Piedmont compete in a competitive employment market.	Believes in the usefulness of ALPR cameras. Believes any decision to issue or renew a contract for ALPRs would require listening to Piedmont residents.
Sunny Bostrom-Fleming	*No response received*	Street and sidewalk paving, plus improvements to police, fire, and school infrastructure.	We need massive community input to ensure we keep our citizens, children, pets, and wildlife safe.	Would use revenue from Measure GG to help to fund increased benefits for the department.	Supports the use of ALPR cameras and believes in their effectiveness in reducing crime. Believes we need to review the 150 agencies receiving this sensitive information.

Athletes of the Weeks

Continued from page 13



Ruthven had against Hogan in last year's Division 2 North Coast Section Individual Tournament.

Henry Stein earns an honorable mention for leading Piedmont to three wins over its last five matches. He scored five goals in the Highlanders 10-9 league win over Castro Valley, while he had a total of 11 goals and 11 assists in four matches at the Monterey Invitational Tournament.

Henry Stein earns an honorable mention for his performance over the last five matches.

Friends of Mountain View Cemetery

18TH ANNUAL PUMPKIN FESTIVAL
SATURDAY, OCTOBER 24, 2026
12:00 – 3:00 PM

Join us at Mountain View Cemetery for a fun-filled day of Halloween events!

***FREE ADMISSION ***

*Free pumpkins(1 per child, while supplies last)
*Craft Area: Treat bags, coloring masks and drawing pages
*FOUR large jumpers for kids of all ages
*Face Painters & Balloon Artists
"Fur, Scales & Tails" Live Animal Show

FOOD TRUCK VENDORS ON SITE FOR PURCHASE

PIEDMONT AVENUE MERCHANTS ASSOCIATION ACTIVITIES:

Costume parade @ 11 am, starts at Piedmont Ave/Montell St
Trick or Treating following parade at designated Candy Stations

Children under the age of 10 MUST be accompanied by an Adult

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www.mountainviewcemetery.org

2026 Calendar of Events

October 14 - October 21

Wednesday, October 14
7:00 p.m. ..... Board of Education meeting ..... City Hall

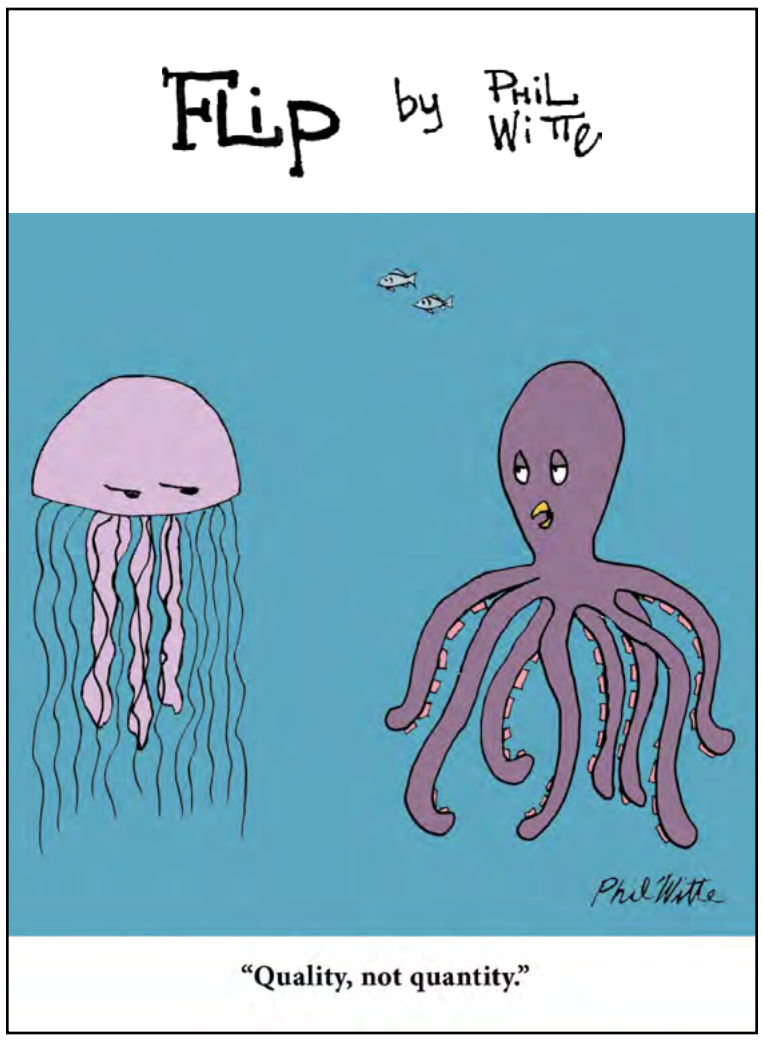
Thursday, October 15
5:30 p.m. ..... State of the City ..... Community Hall

Friday, October 16
5:00 p.m. ..... Food Truck Friday ..... Piedmont Park
6:40 p.m. ..... Movie in the Park ..... Piedmont Park

Monday, October 19
6:00 p.m. ..... City Council meeting..... City Hall

Wednesday, October 21
7:30 p.m. ..... Recreation Commission meeting ..... City Hall

Meetings may be viewed on KCOM (Channel 27) and on the City's website: piedmont.ca.gov.



"Quality, not quantity."

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Where in the World Are We?



School board member Max Roman and Tory enjoying the *Piedmont Post* while on a tour of Rome. The couple stopped by the Colosseum in Rome and paused at the restaurant atop the Palazzo Manfreddi hotel to read the *Piedmont Post*. They then boarded a 7-day Tyrrhenian and Balearic Seas cruise for the Total Solar Eclipse on August 12.

Send your photos of the Post in the far corners of the world, or of other communities named Piedmont, to: WITWAW, 3756 Grand Ave., #203, Oakland, CA 94610.